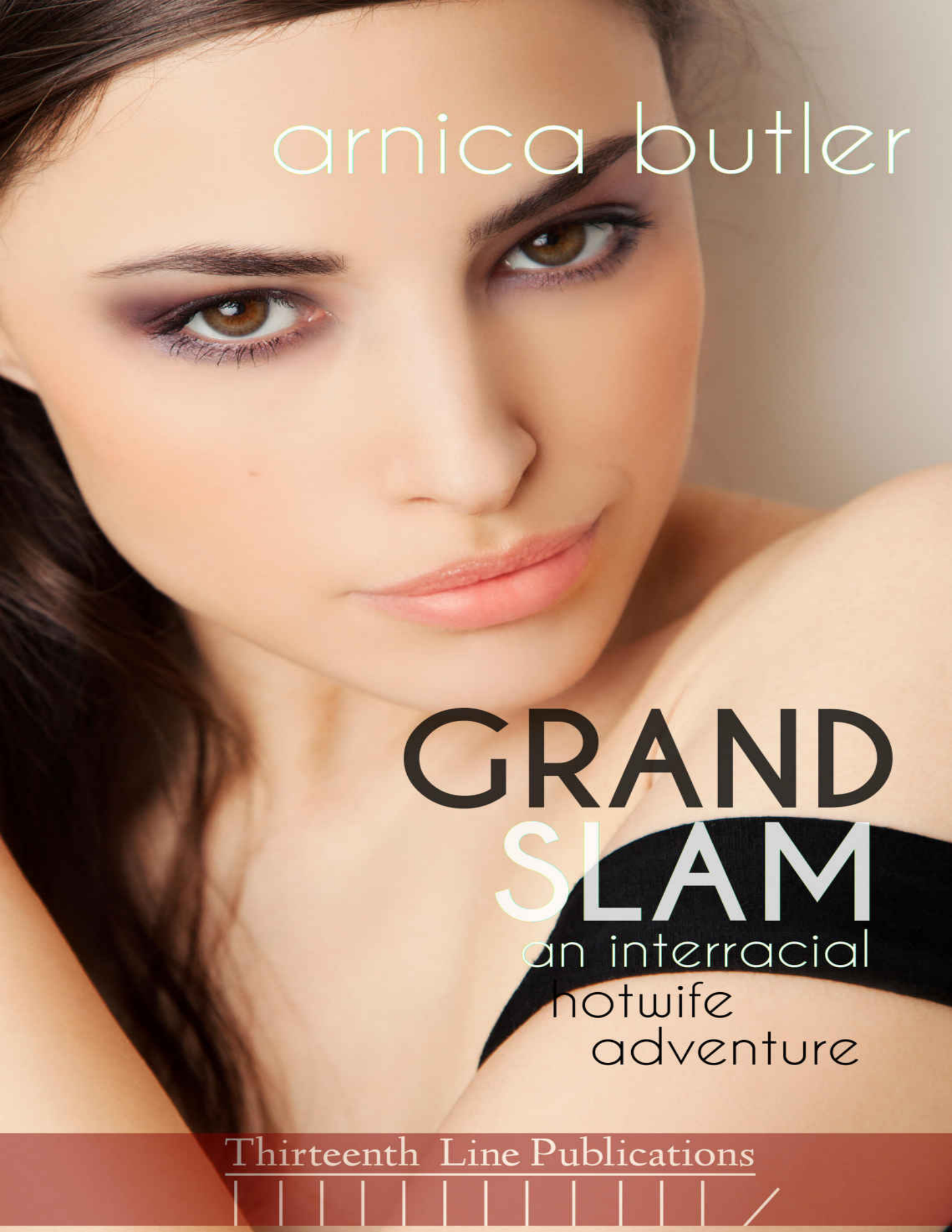




arnica butler

GRAND SLAM

an interracial
hotwife
adventure

Thirteenth Line Publications



GRAND SLAM

An Interracial Hotwife Adventure

By Arnica Butler

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*Undeservedly brief thanks to:
The comma-slaying Watson, the Bardo-loving R., and Kenny
(my thanks are as brief as my timelines).*

*Thank you to readers, especially to those who take the time to review the
works they enjoy. Indie authors could not make it without you.*

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FIRST BASE

Things began in the desert.

“I *knew* it.”

Zoe let out a sigh at the same time that her seatbelt whipped into place and cracked against the window on its way up.

I looked over at her, surprised. Her tone was different than I would expect. Different than the regular Zoe-tone reserved for when I did something wrong.

There was no arguing, though, that “it” was my fault.

Zoe surprised me even more by putting her bare feet up on the dash and hugging her knees. She was wearing loose cutoffs, a bit shorter than “proper.” Sitting the way she was, the full length of her thigh was exposed, all the way to her firm bottom. At thirty-four, Zoe still had the legs of a teenage girl: her thighs were slim and free of even a single dimple. But her legs were also free of that toughened look that most women her age had, if they still possessed nice thighs. If you took a picture of Zoe's thighs, and showed it to any guy, he wouldn't know she wasn't eighteen. Most women went to the gym for thighs like that, and it left a trace of hardness. Or something.

Zoe, on the other hand, walked the dog.

Murphy.

That slobbering mountain of panting fur, a Mastiff-Great Dane mutt. He was the whole reason I had tried a “shortcut.”

Zoe tipped her head back against the headrest and smiled. “Well,” she said. “What now?”

She wasn't angry. In fact, she seemed amused.

I hugged the steering wheel and squinted at her. “That's it?” I said, grinning. “No, 'I-told-you-so?' What *are* you plotting in that head of yours?”

I looked at my phone again.

NO SERVICE.

Zoe smiled and stretched backward as she lowered the seat. She settled into the chair as though she were at the beach, and her breasts – big breasts that were stunningly shaped – rocked slightly to and fro. “*I’m* not up to anything. I am good with *anything* as long as we don’t have the kids.”

Anything. Hmmm.

“Anything?” I queried, and reached out to touch her knee. Things looked promising. We were on an abandoned road, out of gas, nothing better to do in the open plains than have a little “alone” time...

Zoe knocked my hand away with a playful – but firm – flick of her middle finger. Her slender hands could deliver an incredible punch. “We need to conserve our energy, tiger.”

“Someone will come along,” I said, twisting as subtly as I could in my seat.

Her eyes, a pretty amber-brown, flashed at me. “I want to sleep in a bed, tonight, thank you.”

I looked at her reclining form. “I just got so confused,” I said. “You look so relaxed...”

Zoe’s features contorted into a face she made whenever she heard my voice becoming a little – as she called it - “Trashy-French-Loverboy.”

“I’m taking a break before I have to walk for fifty miles,” she said. She closed her eyes as though to emphasize the point.

But still, she seemed amused. I breathed a sigh of relief.

The thing about Zoe, is that generally she is a very nice girl. She goes a little off if she doesn’t have enough food, but for the most part she is pretty pleasant. Compared to a lot of wives.

Unless a situation like this happened.

This was one of those situations where I, Charles Grant, had not only insisted on having things my way, but I had actually *mansplained* the whole thing to my wife. I had explained all about the calculations I had done, and how Google-this-and-Google-that, and it all meant we should bypass a segment of the interstate under construction.

Which, in retrospect, had been ridiculous.

Zoe, after all, had grown up around here.

I stared through the windshield. The situation looked pretty dismal. The road was red-orange dirt, and the only thing distinguishing it from the red-orange dirt that stretched away on either side of it like a dried-blood sea were the sage-colored weeds that clawed their way to the surface every five

feet or so. As if to emphasize our desperate situation, a tumbleweed rolled across the road.

I laughed a little.

“Someone will surely-”

“Nope,” Zoe assured me. She rolled her head from side to side on the headrest.

“We don't really have to walk fifty miles.”

She smiled. Zoe had a mysterious, hard-to-pin-down smile. Like she always knew a little bit more than you, some secret. She might let you in on it, but probably not. No one would ever believe me, given her world-class tits, and her slender thighs, but Zoe's smile was the most erotic thing about her.

She reached behind her without opening her eyes and found a water bottle. “Is this all we have?” she asked, measuring the contents by the weight. Her face was relaxed, and if she hadn't been talking, it would have looked like she was sleeping.

I looked around desperately. “There's a week-old ginger ale under my seat.”

“Take it.”

I looked behind me. “Zo, it makes more sense to go back to the highway. We can -”

“Nope.”

Now, I know what some of you might be thinking. But I can assure you that if you were married to Zoe, and you had just run out of gas on a dusty road somewhere near Nothing At All, you would also just do what I did, which was shut up.

“Okay,” Zoe sighed, after a bit. “Let's get to walking. If we walk fast we can be there by sunset.”

I was 75% sure she was joking.

I fumbled around in the back seat of the car for a sack of some kind, and put the water bottle in it. “Should we take our stuff?” I asked, referring to the small travel bags we had taken with us for our weekend getaway.

Zoe shrugged. “Nah. I don't really want to carry it.”

She lifted a foot to the bumper of the car, and her lean thigh seemed to stretch on forever. I noted, with a mixture of dismay and pleasure, that the cutoffs she was wearing pulled up high on her thigh, and opened up in a very small gap at the bottom. From an angle like this – which of course, I

couldn't imagine anyone having, anytime soon – there was a nice peephole along her inner thigh and up to her white panties. I could feel my cock getting some ideas, in spite of the predicament we were in and how irritating it was. Her panties, my cock continued musing for me, were probably white cotton, plain bikini-cut, like she always wore.

Something about that really turned me on.

She dropped her foot and lifted the other one, while I enjoyed the same show on her other thigh. She was tying her white sneakers on.

I stuffed a few more things into the sack, just in case we ended up on some epic trek through the desert, which is what this was already feeling like. Zoe turned and began to walk down the road.

I fumbled to lock up the car, which we had already pulled off into the tumbleweed-laden dirt. I looked behind us, to the red sea of dust and the air that warped above it in the heat. Mountains cut a gray patch through the blue sky.

Nothing. No one was coming this way. Ever.

“Come on,” Zoe called over her shoulder.

I admired her ass as she walked briskly along. Her cutoffs, I noted, with the same off mixture of feelings, were really too short. They came just below her little bottom, and when she walking quickly as she was now, they rode up with each step, just to where her ass folded into her leg. You almost got to see the little fold, but not quite. Which almost made the cutoffs worse, in the sense that they were more enticing. She had a fairly conservative white t-shirt on, and a white bra that, like her white bikini bottoms, was probably cotton and simple. Somehow this didn't save the outfit from looking a little too..attractive...for walking down a dusty road.

“Well,” I said, panting lightly after the jog I did to catch up to her. “At least we'll get picked up if a car *does* come by.”

“This is a service road for one ranch, some electric station, and at the end, there's a property that got closed off because it was a meth house. No one is coming down this road,” she said, matter-of-factly. She was really clipping it.

“This road dead-ends?” I said.

Zoe smiled her secretive smile again.

There are a lot of times in my marriage when I curse myself for being so attracted to that smile. It's all fine, all fun and games, when you're in a city and across a nice table of food and alcohol, and Zoe is wearing some

stunning dress, and she smiles at you like that. But in a situation like this, Zoe's smile was infuriating.

Hot.

But infuriating.

"So what, then?" I said. I was cranky now, and it was coming across in my voice. I hated that Zoe could get under my skin like that. I hate-loved it. But like all men (at least I suspect), I liked to be in control. Of *everything*. That included whatever it was that Zoe had planned once we got to the end of this road.

She waved a hand at me absent-mindedly. "You'll see," she said.

So aggravating.

"That's it," I said, stopping. "Let's head back to the highway."

Zoe turned to me and rolled her eyes. "You're such a control freak," she laughed. "Okay, okay. The highway," she said, extending her tanned, long arm in the direction of the car, which now glinted in the distance, a single piece of metal on the vast red ocean, "is about twenty clicks that way. Oooooorrrr...we could go down here," she pointed behind her with her thumb, "and climb over a little hill and go to Martha's Diner on County Road 41."

Things like this. All the time. It's almost certainly why I married her, and yet it's almost certainly why I have the occasional sensation in my temples like I'm going to have a stroke.

And then, for no apparent reason, she grabbed the bottom of her shirt and lifted it over her head.

"What are you doing?" I said. I whisper-yelled, and looked around, as if there were anyone or anything that could see my wife.

"It's too hot."

I grimaced.

"There's no one here," she said.

And then, like she always did, she got with her sweet voice. "Come on," she smiled. "Let's make it there by snack time."

In spite of having had two kids, Zoe's stomach was not much changed. She was lean as ever but she had always had a little roundness, Bardo-esque, to her belly. I think she sometimes envied the flat-as-a-board model stomachs, but personally, I found hers much hotter than theirs. Not that I needed to worry that most people would be looking at her stomach, no

matter how pretty it was, because her breasts were in full view, pressed up against the confines of her white bra. And they *always* stole the show.

I stared at the bra. “Zoe...” I began.

“No one. Is here. We can see a car coming from seventy miles away.”

She turned, and began to walk again.

So I followed her.

It ended up being about an hour of walking in the baking sun, but after about twenty minutes our destination unfolded at the bottom of a lightly-sloping expanse of hill and we could at least see it. An area framed by tattered yellow police tape, with a large cement slab inside of it, announced itself as the former meth house. Beyond that, there was indeed a low hill of red rock.

From there, it was all downhill, and just when I began to despair, a hot breeze picked up – and while it was a little like being blasted in the face by an oven, it was better than the still air that had been squeezing us so far. I had sweat through my shirt, given up, and taken it off, even though at thirty-five I was hardly in the shape I would like to have been in. A few too many beers had overstayed their usefulness.

Sweat had beaded all over Zoe's skin, but instead of pouring off of her unattractively, as it was surely doing on me, it had given her a nice, damp sheen. She had tied her thick, dark hair up, but strands of it were coming loose and sticking to her neck.

“My head is so hot,” she said, out of nowhere.

“I was just thinking of your head,” I quipped.

“I doubt that very much,” she said, coyly. “But seriously. Feel it.”

She patted her hair, and looked at me expectantly. I reached out and touched the thick pile of arrow-straight, chocolate-black hair. “That is pretty warm.”

She patted my head. I have a nondescript shade of blonde hair. She frowned at me. My head was evidently not hot enough to compliment her misery.

We kept walking.

The sun was behind us by the time we arrived at the hill of rocks, which had grown considerable and looked much more formidable now that we were next to it. There was no shade. I felt a flush rising up to my

forehead. "I think I'm going to pass out," I said, putting my hands on my head.

Zoe squinted at me through her sunglasses. "It's just over this ridge."

I looked up at the rocks. "You're sure."

Zoe was already starting in on the first big boulder. I watched her with fascination. She had grown up here, on the Western slope of Colorado, and apparently all anyone did for fun was climb around on these fucking rocks. Which made sense, because that's all there was in the whole godforsaken place. That, and cattle. Zoe's fingers worked their way into crevices and crannies, and her feet found toeholds with lightening efficiency. Her small, muscled frame bounced up, up, up the rocks in what seemed like less than a minute.

"Jesus," I muttered under my breath.

I am also a highly competitive person in general. I do not like to lose races or competitions of any kind. I am no star athlete, but I'm pretty good at everything I take up. I hated when Zoe did shit like this.

I clambered up the hill with considerably less grace than my wife, who was standing on one of the top rocks, cutoffs flared away from her thighs and giving me a nice view of her panties again.

I scrambled up the rocks next to her and looked down.

And there, indeed, in fact no more than twenty feet away if you dropped straight down, was a diner.

"Zoe," I hissed.

She looked down at me.

"Your shirt!"

Because in addition to the diner, there were trucks and motorcycles scattered all over the parking lot adjacent to it, and a variety of plaid shirts with hard-looking faces above them, all looking up at the scene on the top of the ridge. I heard a whistle.

Zoe, slipped her shirt over her head. One might have described the way she did it as laboriously. Then she started to slide down the hill along what seemed to be a runoff path. She gathered speed as she went, but she hopped off the last five feet of the hill and sprang neatly along on the pavement.

A group of guys who had been getting into their trucks stopped to watch her. I heard the low rumble of their voices as they made some kind of "little joke" to her, the kind any asshole guy is going to make to a woman,

especially one as attractive as Zoe, who just pops out of nowhere like that. Breasts bouncing. Cutoffs sliding up her thighs.

I began to maneuver myself into position to slide down the same way Zoe had. The guys were pointing at her now, and I saw Zoe give a half pivot and look down the length of her leg. She had a long scratch from her ass to her mid-thigh, it looked like...and it also looked like one of the thick-limbed truck drivers was *going to his car for a first aid kit* while the other two kept an eye on Zoe's thigh.

"You gotta be fucking kidding me," I mumbled, pitching any caution to the wind and starting to slide down the "path."

Okay, word to the wise who have maybe never slid down a drainage route on a desert rock hill. It's a dangerous fucking endeavor. I'm not sure what I did differently than Zoe, but I started an avalanche of small rocks that went pitching ahead of me, hit me in the back from behind, and generally made me look like an ass. The rocks tumbled off the last little cliff of the hill and bounced dangerously close to Zoe and the truckers, who jumped out of the way and looked up at me with disdain.

I also couldn't slow myself down, so I went flying off the end of the hill and landed fairly ungracefully next to them.

The first trucker was returning from his cab. He was holding a bottle of hydrogen peroxide in one hand, and a cotton ball in the other. He squinted when he saw me, and I could see that the other three were none too happy to see that the bouncing-breasted, slender-thighed woman who had tumbled down the mountain came with a side of husband.

Even if that husband was such an obvious jackass.

"Hi," I said jovially. "Just out for a little hike."

One of the truckers snorted, and I decided to take it, optimistically, as a sign of my joke landing.

I reached for the hydrogen peroxide and cotton ball. "Here we go – thanks," I said to the man, who was every inch the stereotypical trucker: tattoos, thick arms and neck, permanent scowl. "I'll do that for you, Zoe. *My love.*"

The scratch on Zoe's thigh was the superficial sort she herself would have ignored. I patted it dutifully with the cotton ball, keenly aware that the three of them were staring at her leg and happily so, under the guise of caring about her medical care. I handed the hydrogen peroxide back to the trucker. "Er...yeah, thanks." *For looking at my wife's ass, you fucker.*

“Thank you,” Zoe said. Her voice was really thick with appreciation. I cast her a look.

Did her voice also seem sultry or something?

She gave me her mystery-smile, and pushed her hair out of her face. To the trucker she said: “Buy you a coffee or something?”

The big man looked suddenly sheepish. “No ma'am,” he said. “Just helpin' out. Gotta run. Deadline.”

And then I felt sort of silly. The three guys were just teddy bears. They dispersed, waving and giving us the sage advice not to climb around on these rock piles.

“Moab,” one of them said, chewing on a toothpick. “That's were y'all go climbing.”

I watched as Zoe smiled at him – not her mysterious smile, a smile I would have to characterize as “inviting.” Her lips were closed- Zoe rarely smiled widely – and her eyes seemed to gleam. She lifted a hand and opened and closed it as they walked away.

“Well,” I said, brushing my hands off. “That certainly was fun. I *especially* liked the part where you flirted shamelessly with a bunch of truckers. Let's get something to drink, shall we?”

Zoe leaned over and kissed me on the cheek. Her skin was still shiny with sweat, and somehow, from the waist up, she had escaped the dust of the hill entirely. “It was just a little fun,” she said.

And that's when I had this feeling. It wasn't necessarily the first time I'd ever had a feeling like that – seeing Zoe interacting with any other man had always brought out a little twinge of jealousy, and it had a curious, sweet aftertaste to it, but this was different. This was a whole, solid slice of excitement. I felt my cock twitch with her words.

“They have beer here?” I said.

“You won't need it,” Zoe said, trotting toward the entrance, dragging the eyes of every man in the parking lot with her as she went. “We'll be back on the road in no time.”

She pulled the door open, and, just for a moment, I had that same feeling again, as I watched her pass through the door and into the diner. Like she wasn't even my wife; that I was just another man staring at her from the parking lot.

I looked over at the cluster of guys in the lot. They were definitely watching her. A guy in a Metallica t-shirt with cut-off sleeves raised his

hand to me in a mock salute.

I don't exactly know how to describe the feeling it gave me. It twisted in my stomach.

It was not new for guys to be checking out Zoe. She is an attractive woman, well above what most people would expect a guy like me to be able to get my hands on, let alone marry. But generally, Zoe wore scrubs and had her hair in a bun and didn't wear makeup, so the full impact of her appearance was a little dulled. Her cutoffs had surprised me when she wore them on the first day of our getaway, in fact, but it hadn't occurred to me to complain. Until we ended up at the truck stop diner with all these burly men staring at her.

I wiped my brow, tried to look cool, and went in behind her.

The realization hit me maybe halfway down the aisle. The bad thing.

Zoe was sitting there, her white shirt slightly damp against her chest, her face caught in the fading light of the afternoon through the window. Already seated. She looked at me and smiled, one corner of her mouth turning up at the side. She was happy. This was the kind of thing she weathered really well, once she got over her initial irritation.

I slid into the booth.

"I'll have a huge glass of water," she said to the waitress. "And a -"

I reached out and grabbed her hand. "How about just water for now?" I said, turning to the waitress and smiling. I could feel the ripple of anger steaming up Zoe's face before I turned back to her. She *hated* when I tried to tell her what to order, or eat, or wear, or cook for dinner, or generally do.

"It's not what you think," I hissed at her across the table. "I just...I left my wallet in the car."

Zoe's hand flew to her mouth, and for a second I thought maybe she was going to cry.

Instead, a hugely amused laugh tumbled into her cupped hand.

"Ohhhhh my goood," she chortled.

I shook my head. "It's not funny."

She wiped her nose and dabbed at her eye with a napkin. "I know. It's not. It's really not. Except it is."

We sat in silence while the waitress set the glasses of water down in front of us. She looked from me to Zoe and back again, sighed when we didn't order anything else, and walked away giving us the sense she would never come back.

Zoe moved the straw up and down in her drink. "What the hell did you pack in that bag then?"

I took out my phone. "We'll just call Triple A." My phone blinked at me.

For some reason Zoe's face went a little pale as I dialed.

She reached out and grabbed the phone out of my hand.

I stared at her. Her smile was a little less amused now.

"I, uh...forgot to pay that," she said.

I cocked my head.

At this point, it bears mentioning that bill-paying was the central element of an ongoing marital battle between us. A sort of friendly banter with a sour edge. There really isn't any point going into the boring details; anyone who is married or has had a roommate knows the drill.

"Oooohhhh," I said. "You *forgot*."

Zoe's eyes flickered a little, and she folded her arms over her chest and leaned back against the booth.

"Yep," she said, with a very plosive "p." "*I forgot*."

I had a feeling that this was cue for me to remember something I myself had forgotten.

Unfortunately, I had in fact forgotten forgetting whatever that was, and I didn't need Zoe gathering any more evidence that my memory sucked. Zoe was compiling that case like she was taking it to the Supreme Court someday.

I decided to deke.

I put my head in my hands. "Oh god," I murmured. "I don't want to climb that hill again."

Zoe laughed again. I could scarcely imagine why this was all so amusing to her, but I was grateful it wasn't pissing her off. "What a classic idiotic move," I continued, hoping to take her mind off Charles's Terrible Memory Exhibit #1,956.

She gave me her little mystery smile and began dialing the phone.

"What are you doing?" I mouthed. She just gave me that smile again.

"Abby. This is Zoe. Listen, I'm sorry to leave this on a message, but we're not going to make it back tonight. Car trouble. I hope you can watch Murphy one more night? I'll make it up to with wine." She kissed the phone.

Murphy. Staying with our elderly next-door neighbor, because Zoe's parents wouldn't have him in their house. Abby drank a whole bottle of wine every night and made no apologies for it, but she seemed perfectly capable of letting Murphy in and out the door. She liked talking to him while she drank. The only problem was that she sometimes forgot to feed the poor beast, and he was too mellow of a dog to complain. Once, we left him with her for two weeks and he lost almost ten pounds.

Zoe had dialed again, her slender fingers working nimbly. She called in to work, she called her parents, she called a hotel and made a reservation, rattling off the credit card number she had memorized along with all the other numbers in her keen little head. Then she handed me the phone back. Another sly little smile.

"Playing hooky," I said. "That's...not like you."

She stretched her arms over the back of the booth and sighed. "I have to say, I'm just so burnt out on those kids. This is the perfect excuse for getting an extra day out of this deal."

I must have frowned a little, because the truth was, we really couldn't afford it, and the mounting expenses before us, like a cab ride to the car, or at least a gas station, and the hotel, were starting to bother me.

"Don't," she said. "What's done is done. Let's just have fun."

Another enigmatic smile.

"We still have to sort this car bit out," I said. "Where's that hotel?"

"Outside of Grand Junction," she said.

This was two hours away. What the hell was her plan?

"Don't get pissy with me," she chirped.

"It's just...how are we going to get to the car, get my wallet, get back here, get the gas, get back there...it'll be hours, and then..."

"Why do you think I just made all those phone calls?" she snapped. She was annoyed now.

"You're the one who didn't pay AAA," I said.

"You're the one who forgot your wallet."

"You're the one who thinks we're just made of money and we can just stay an extra night here or there no big deal."

This was dangerously close to the sharp edge of our financial woes, and I saw Zoe's eyes narrow.

"You're the *idiot* who took this stupid shortcut."

“So we wouldn't be sitting in traffic for four hours burning gasoline like it's free.”

“This weekend was your idea, so don't go pinning all the expenses on me.”

Zoe's voice was hard-edged now. How did this conversation get here this fast?

I looked down at my empty water glass. I assumed the waitress was never coming back for two losers with no money, so I was waiting for the ice to melt.

“I *can't believe* you forgot to pay AAA,” I said. It was a compulsion. The words were out of my mouth before I could stop them.

I knew I was being an ass.

My wife's face went to Defcon 5. It doesn't look like much, if you don't know her. Her features are so naturally pleasant and they don't really draw into any kind of menacing look. Maybe it's something about her eyes, like they turn black or something. Anyway, she looks demonic without really changing her expression.

“That again,” she said, and each word felt like a serrated knife on my skin.

“Okay,” she said, with false and frightening cheer. “If this whole thing is *my* fault, then I'll just go ahead and solve the problem *myself*.”

“Oh god,” I sighed. “You don't have to be dramatic. I'll take care of it.” And then I couldn't stop this next bit: “As usual.”

I shouldn't have added that, I knew.

“Tell you what,” Zoe's knife-edged voice said. She leaned over the counter. “You go ahead and do whatever big, manly, magnanimous, difficult, horrible, downtrodden, brow-beaten, generous, *masculine* thing you have to do.” She took my hand in hers and patted it condescendingly with her other hand. “And I'll do my thing. And we'll just see. Okay? We'll see who gets this problem solved faster.”

She rose like an angry goddess, and turned neatly on her heel. She went to the restroom.

It's a moment I look back on, and wonder about. Sure, a lot of other things happened between then and now, but in retrospect, that was a real harbinger-type moment.

Sure thing, I remember thinking.

At the same time, I was pretty much up for anything.

Anything, I was thinking, to avoid climbing up that hill again. I popped an ice cube into my mouth. I had no idea what harebrained plan Zoe thought she would come up with, but I was certainly interested in seeing what it was.

When Zoe emerged from the bathroom, there was something different about her appearance. Quite a bit different about her appearance.

I noticed the obvious first. She had taken her hair down, and shaken it out so that all of its arrow-straight, chocolate-black glory was shining like a polished wood. Even in the heat and under the duress of sweat, Zoe's hair was indestructible.

She gave her hair a toss and walked toward the booth where we had been sitting. I was still buzzing around in my own mind, trying to identify what it was that was so different about her. And then she met my eye, and the corner of her mouth turned up in her mischievous smile. Then something hit me in the face.

An actual thing. Smacked me right in the face.

I gave a start, and the item dropped onto the table and partially into my water. I started to hold it up, but as soon as I recognized it, a cold sensation spread out in my limbs and I dropped it into my lap, bunching it up so it wouldn't be seen.

It was her bra.

I moved to the other side of the booth, and watched her.

Now, maybe I should have done something else. I can imagine someone thinking that, if they're reading this. Maybe, instead of watching my wife prance past me to the counter where a line of torn vinyl stools butted up to a cracked linoleum bar, maybe I should have gotten up and sat next to her.

Instead, I watched her with fascination as she sat down on the stool, and shook her hair again. Her full breasts were no longer harnessed into the round spheres that her bra formed them into. They were pert and turned upward a little near the full bottom of the curve. And her light brown nipples were hard little knobs that very clearly pressed against the thin material of her white shirt. To top things off, the sun was streaming in through the window *just so*, penetrating the fabric of her shirt and giving anyone looking from my direction a full and unobstructed view of the exact contours of my wife's breasts.

She stretched her lean legs out under the counter, and the cutoffs slid on the vinyl and up to practically mid-ass.

I was so taken by the sight, and wondering what was going on in that devious little head of hers, and so surprised by her behavior – because Zoe just wasn't...well, like this...that it took me a moment to notice the rest of the diner.

There were probably only five guys in there, in reality. In my memory, it seems like hundreds, but I already know that I'm prone to exaggerate things. The whole place seemed to ripple as she sat down. I could feel the heavy, magnetic shift of male energy, all of it directing itself right toward my wife. I looked around. Two men in a booth on that side of the restaurant were looking right at her ass, which probably looked stunning, pushed out into a plump heart on top of the stool, its firmness obvious by the way it didn't sink into the material. Another man was on the L-shape arm of the counter, and his eyes were affixed to her tits.

She spoke to the waitress, and whatever she said must have garnered sympathy. The waitress gave me a look, but it was more confused than anything.

So now I guess I was putting the main elements of Zoe's plan together. And between her hyperbolic outburst and this little show, I have to say I was largely pissed off at her at this point. What was she trying to prove, anyway? That tits got more attention than cocks at a truck stop? I felt my face flush with rage.

I wanted to just go and grab her, and tell her to get her bra back on and stop acting like a little brat. But that was just what she wanted, I knew.

I found a newspaper on the seat and shook it out with relish, holding it up and in front of my view. It made a dramatic sound, so I was pretty pleased with myself. *Do what you like*, I was essentially saying. *I don't care*.

Except for a few things. One: I *did* care. And two: the angry, jealous feeling that Zoe was kicking around in my stomach had sort of dripped down and into my crotch, where it was actually working to...

I shifted.

Yep. Hard as a rock.

The door bell jingled, and I fought the urge to look over the top of the newspaper. It was probably someone leaving. Zoe would just love it if I looked over there, and I wasn't going to do it.

I probably made it five minutes. After a while I realized that I was holding up a farming community newspaper, and that 95% of the pages were filled with ads for tractors, and that I hadn't turned the page the whole time.

I folded it neatly, my eyes on the paper with great deliberate effort, before I looked up at where Zoe was sitting at the counter.

Of course. Of course the guy who had walked into the diner had sat next to her. He was lean, wiry with that working-man strength that made him look like he might wrestle a cow to the ground. A peppering of five o'clock shadow (how apt, since it was four pm) covered his square jaw. But he had one of those honest, down-home rancher faces.

Heat seemed to spread out all over me. I watched Zoe toss her hair again, swiveling on the stool just ever-so slightly toward the trucker. She brought her finger to her mouth, and *bit* it.

Oh this was really too much.

At the same time, I was enjoying the show a *little* bit. There was something so voyeuristic about watching her from afar like that, watching her very deliberately flirt with this guy. Her sexiness seemed to come sharply into focus, where it had been sort of blurred out for me for a long time. I watched her twirl her ankle playfully, smile her “cute” smile, the one that showed her teeth and was absolutely fake. Her fingers tapped across her lips.

The trucker bought her some french fries. How sweet, I grumbled inwardly. She held onto them with her long fingers and nibbled at the ends like a sixteen-year old in some eighties movie. She let out a laugh, and threw her head back, exposing her swan-like neck.

I couldn't hear the conversation, but I didn't need to.

This went on for about fifteen minutes, and the whole time I just stared at her, transfixed by her moderately lewd behavior, and the effect it was having on me. I forgot all about my mandate to try and solve our problem. My thoughts started to slide to some pretty dirty places.

I watched as she stood up, and I heard the phrase “don't mind givin' you a lift,” come out of the trucker's mouth.

And then, Zoe shot me one cool look. It was triumphant. Sexy. Infuriating. Anger shot through me, with a healthy dose of jealousy. But also I found her strangely alluring in that moment. Whatever it was that I was feeling, the combination paralyzed me.

She took a piece of paper from the waitress and wrote something on it.

And then she walked out the door.

With the trucker.

Okay, I thought. She was surely having a laugh at my expense.

Surely, she would not actually go so far as to go off with this guy.

It was a game of chicken.

I lifted the water glass and slurped the bit of water that the melted ice had given me. I looked away, because if I watched her out here, I knew I'd lose my cool and chase after her.

When I looked back, the only thing left of my wife was her lean thigh, and it quickly disappeared behind a closing door.

I stood up.

The trucker was in the truck.

"The fuck?" I said aloud. I ran to the door, but the big rig was already humming, slowly rolling.

Zoe turned to me and gave me that wry smile. Then she flapped her hand open and closed, in one final infuriating wave.

She pointed to the diner, and then she was gone.

"Seriously?" I said. Again aloud. To no one.

I went back inside after about five minutes of standing there open-mouthed. At the last minute, I had the presence of mind to mentally note the truck's license plate.

I threw the door open and stomped into the diner. As soon as I did I realized I didn't know what I was doing. And that my wife's bra was still balled up in my fist.

I sat down in the same booth.

I stared out the window.

All kinds of thought were going through my head. First of all, what a stupid, dangerous, idiotic thing to do. Second of all...well, second of all, some new thoughts. Some very new thoughts. And they wouldn't stop bubbling to the surface of my mind.

One fantasy played out in a brief moment before the waitress appeared next to the booth. In it, the trucker pulled over about half a mile down the road, and turned to Zoe. "Let's talk payment," the trucker said.

And Zoe smiled her little smile, then leaned over to take his big trucker cock in his mouth...

The waitress slammed a half-eaten plate of french fries and a glass of water on the table. "This is fer you," she said gruffly. "And this." She placed a folded piece of paper on the table.

I reached for the waitress's arm as she turned to walk away. "You know that guy, that woman just left with?"

"Who, Daryl?" she squawked.

I don't know, you fucking toad, who Daryl is, I seethed inwardly.

"The guy in the red shirt," I said.

"Daryl."

I took a deep breath. "Okay so you know him."

"He's a nice enough fella," she said. Then she turned and snorted. "I wouldn't kick him outta bed."

The man who had been staring at my wife's ass snorted a little. He looked at me and shook his head.

I opened the note.

Back in an hour. Problem solved. Eat my fries.

And then, at the bottom:

I win.

And a very uncharacteristic, very sweet heart, with a smiley face in the center of it.

The waitress took pity on me and agreed to bring me a cup of coffee and let me sit in the booth getting endless refills, while a cool rain came in from nowhere and then blew out and the whole place dried up like it had never happened. I promised her a big tip as soon as I had my wallet.

Hours went by. Not one, but several. And they went by as slow as possible, while I imagined every awful scenario I could come up with.

And every awful-sounding, but slightly delicious scenario I could come up with.

You see, it was a truth I had never quite admitted to myself, but a truth nonetheless, that I enjoyed thinking about my wife with other men. It was a fantasy I had only entertained with Zoe, maybe because Zoe was so far out of my league.

When I first began to imagine scenarios involving her, late at night, while I was starting to fall asleep, I figured it was just my insecurity. I even

talked myself into believing that they weren't fantasies, as in, I didn't enjoy them. They were intrusive thoughts, the kind that keep you up at night.

I was able to tell myself that I didn't deliberately conjure them. That I didn't really *want* to think about Zoe with another man. It just happened.

I managed to keep telling myself that, even after I read some unrelated article about a forgery crime ring that had been busted up in Florida, and the unusual and sordid details of all the participants. One of which was that the originator of the fraud had a wife who had built up an extraordinary following on the internet as a hotwife.

I managed to tell myself that I had zero interest in the topic, even as I went onto the internet in search of videos with the man's wife in them. And even when, after I couldn't find them, I delved into the world of hotwifing porn wholeheartedly.

Even when I sometimes imagined Zoe sitting across the table from me at dinner, setting down her fork, and telling me there was something she wanted to try.

Even when I had to get out of bed at two in the morning and jerk off in the shower because I had spent the hours between 11pm and 2am imagining my wife giving me the most filthy porn performances imaginable, with man after man, while I just watched.

And I had never, to my recollection, so much as hinted to Zoe that I did this late at night.

I barely admitted it to myself, after all.

So of all the things I should have been thinking about or feeling as I sat there in that diner, the thing I remember imagining most was this:

Zoe put her feet up on the dash of the cab. She showed Daryl her lean thigh, and her cutoffs crept up to the middle of her small, hard ass. Then she let her thigh flop open a little. From where he was sitting, bouncing a little as the big rig rumbled along, Daryl could see into her cutoffs, all the way to her white panties.

Or maybe she had taken those off, too. He couldn't see the tiny patch of straight black hair she left as a landing strip, only the bare waxed folds of her cunt.

No, maybe her panties. White cotton panties, the only thing he needed to slide out of the way when he got his rough hands into those cutoffs.

"More coffee?!" the waitress would scream, in the middle of my fantasy. I would nod.

"I'd hate for you have to drive out of your way when you have a big load to deliver," Zoe said.

I know. It's porno-grade cliché.

"I wish there were something I could do to make it up to you."

Daryl smiled. He pulled over the rig, right there on the side of the road. "I do have a big load."

Zoe laughed appreciatively.

No.

Zoe gave her wry little smile. Then she slid her hands up, beneath her shirt, to cup her full breasts. "It's so hot," she complained.

"Sorry. No AC," Daryl would say. They were both sweating. Zoe's pretty skin was damp and shiny.

She slid her shirt over her head, and her big tits swayed for a moment.

Zoe's tits were the definition of come-on-me tits. There was just something about the round shape of them, the way they were too big for her small frame but nice and firm, the way they turned up at the ends, a little like her personality: round and full but with just a little bit of a snarl to her.

"What if I help you out?" Zoe said, her neat and tidy lips all contorted with her filthy words. She ran her tongue along her top lip, climbed onto all fours on the big, wide seat of the cab, and crawled over to Daryl. Her fingers went to work on his fly, while he watched her breasts dangling in front of him.

Here is where the fantasy always snagged a bit. After my wife gave Daryl her little smile, what would she do? Would she lower her head and take him into her mouth?

Probably not. She wasn't really into it all that much.

Oh well. It was my fantasy. So much the better if she did.

Zoe leaned over, pushing her long hair over one shoulder. Then she opened her mouth and took the whole huge slab of Daryl's meat into her throat. He placed his hand on her head and watched her bob up and down on his cock. She slurped and gagged, and finally, with a little push from his rough, rancher's hand, she went all the way to his fat balls. Her lips grazed his hairy sack, and then she went back to work again, up and down.

As she worked on his cock with her mouth, she slid both of her hands back and slipped her cutoffs and white panties over the pretty hill of her

ass. Daryl watched as her fingers lingered there, playing with herself where he couldn't see. Inviting him to get at what he wanted.

Zoe paused her blowjob to give him his chance. She pressed her lips to the tip of his cock and kissed it. It was too much for him. With the artful moves of a man in a fantasy sex-scene, he flipped her over so that her legs, caught up in her panties and jeans, were up by her head. Her snatch was open to him now, and dripping wet. He guided his cock to the glistening center of her pussy, and slid the fat head around, over her clit, making her squeal in pleasure just before he sank his whole cock inside of her.

His thick, veined cock, pink like a pig, slammed into her. She squeaked and panted with every thrust until finally she bucked against him and smashed her body up against his, impaling herself on his fat cock as she came hard. Her juices squelched around him, leaking from the tight seal her lips made around his dick. And then, he gave a few more thrusts and yanked his pulsing meat from inside her just in time to spurt rope after rope of his cum over her breasts and thighs.

Zoe rubbed her tits together, working his seed into her skin. She moved her hands over her legs and rubbed his cum into her slender thighs.

Then she took her forefinger and wiped up a big glob that had splattered right on her taint, mingled with her own cum. She brought her finger to her mouth and sucked it off with a wet slurp.

I exhaled sharply. This last bit of my fantasy replayed over and over again in my mind.

I know.

I'm a lewd and filthy-minded man.

"More?" the waitress slurred, without looking down at me. "Hey Brady, you gotta tab with me so don't you sneak outta here like that!" she screamed. She poured me a quarter of a refill without looking and took off after Brady.

My cock was hard as a rock.

She wouldn't do anything like that, Zoe.

Surely she wouldn't.

But what if he just flirted with her? Of course he *would*. He would ask her what she did, where she was from.

Would Zoe tell him the truth? Would she name her kids and her husband, and sit like a lady instead of putting her feet up on the dash.

Or would she fan herself with her hands and give him that wry smile instead?

I felt pretty ill by the time I saw the silver glint of our car rolling slowly into the parking lot.

I was shaking when I told Maureen, the waitress, that I would just grab some cash and be right back.

"Take it easy on the caffeine," she remarked.

Zoe emerged from the car. "Hey," she said.

I embraced her, and I can admit that I did it a little more dramatically than I needed to. I clutched her hair and smelled it, and smelled her neck. And it's true: I was searching for the scent of naughtiness on her. Cologne, the bleachy stink of another man's cum, the odor of his sweat: anything to tell me that she had been too close to Daryl.

"Jesus," she said, rolling her eyes. "It's like I'm coming home from the war. Here, leave a tip for the waitress," she said, sticking a twenty into my hand.

I paid Maureen, and when I came out, Zoe was sitting in the passenger seat, her feet up on the dashboard. I was shaking as I sat down in the driver's seat.

"So," I said, readjusting the mirrors and seat. "How was your ride with Daryl?"

Zoe threw her head back against the headrest. She rolled her face in my direction, and smiled at me.

That smile. Just the corner of her mouth. "Oh," she said lightly. "Fine."

"Fine, huh. Two and a half hours worth of fine."

My voice sounded a little angrier than I meant it to. A little angrier, in fact, than I even felt. After all, it was ridiculous, talking to her like that, when everything I was sort of accusing her of with that tone was a sick fantasy I had cooked up in my own mind.

Shit, I thought. I had just started another fight. And Zoe would be totally justified in being mad at me. I was acting like an idiot. A jealous idiot, hopped up on his own fantasies.

Instead, Zoe brought her thumb to her mouth and bit the tip of it. She flicked it, and the small click of her fingernail seemed unusually loud. "And just what is it you think I was doing all that time?" she said.

She wasn't angry. She was grinning.

I was backing up, and I had pretty much forgotten what I was even doing. Luckily, I looked in the rear-view at that moment, and slammed on the brakes as the cab of a white truck filled the entire mirror.

“What the fuck, buddy?” someone yelled.

I waved my hand in the air and threw the car into first.

Zoe gave a light laugh and looked behind her. She smiled again.

Then she turned back to me.

I had forgotten her question. I had forgotten pretty much everything I needed to know, like how to drive properly. My mind was racing at a speed I never thought it would race again in my lifetime, and blood was pumping hard to every part of my body *but* my mind.

What the fuck was Zoe up to? That was the question. And why was Zoe doing it?

But Zoe slid her hand over my thigh, and her fingers brushed over the shape of my cock in my jeans. Her touch sent a shockwave of electricity through me, and I shuddered.

“I guess I should be asking...what is it you *wanted* me to be doing with Daryl?”

I didn't answer. I could barely breathe.

In the corner of my eye, I could see Zoe smile.

There was a long pause. Maybe we went a few miles, maybe more.

“Stay on this road and it connects to a highway that takes us in to Grand Junction,” she said. “I don't know the name of it.”

A pause.

“Are you going to tell me?” she purred.

“What?” I breathed.

“What you wanted me to do with Daryl. And then I can tell you...”

Surely there was only a second, maybe even half a second, between “you” and the next thing she said. But it felt like forever, waiting for the words her lips would form next. Her mouth twitched at the corner, teasing me.

“...if I did it.”

I wiped my brow. I was sweating profusely, in the air conditioning.

“Zoe please,” I whispered. “I'm trying to drive.”

She smiled this way she does, when she finds something amusing in a way that favors her somehow. She bites the tip of her tongue while she smiles like this.

My cock throbbed.

Focus, Charles. Drive the car.

I clutched the steering wheel with two hands, and tried hard to think about something un-sexy.

“Does Abby have enough food for Murphy?”

Zoe just giggled, leaned back, and closed her eyes.

She knew my game.

I couldn't take it anymore.

“So?” I said, reaching out and sliding the towel up and over her ass. She turned around and sat down on the bed opposite me. Her eyes were challenging. She grinned and uncapped her lotion. “So?” she parroted.

She rubbed the lotion between her hands and then began to spread it onto her arms in long strokes. She let the towel fall down as she rubbed more into her chest. All the while she looked at me, her grin getting more and more gloating.

“Why were you so late getting back?”

Her grin twitched, ever-so-slightly. “You mean with Daryl?”

I glared at her. A fun glare, but a glare nonetheless.

She smiled.

“We took a wrong turn,” she said.

“Hmm.”

Another smile. She put more lotion in her hand and rubbed it together to warm it up.

“That's it?” I said, finally.

“It was a really, *really* wrong turn,” she said. Her voice was edged with double-innuendo, I could tell. Her eyes were lit up with mischief.

I hadn't seen this Zoe for a long time.

She stood up, and tossed the towel away on the floor.

“How wrong?” I said.

Zoe climbed onto my lap and pulled my shirt over my head from behind. Her skin was still damp from her shower and she smelled like hotel soap. For some reason this excited me even more. I had spent a lot of time imagining that I smelled hotel soap, some unmistakable scent like the Westin, on her one night when she came home late.

She moved her hand between my legs, and slid her fingers into the flap of my boxers. She raised her eyebrows when her fingers touched my

cock. It was hard and I could feel that it was sticky with precum.

No hiding my excitement.

She leaned to my ear. Her fingers closed around my cock.

“Very, very, very wrong,” she whispered.

My cock pulsed, and she smiled.

“Huh,” she said, leaning back.

Then her smile again.

“A big truck like that,” she said, “is very hard to turn around.”

“Is it?” I think I said. She was guiding my hand with hers to her pussy, and my fingers were knuckle-deep in wet, velvet flesh.

I pushed her onto the opposite bed.

“You must have felt pretty bad,” I ventured. “Making him go all that way out of his way.” I pushed my boxers down gruffly.

Zoe propped herself up on her elbows. “I did,” she said.

“So how did you make up for it?” I said.

I didn't care that I was baring my fantasy to her at this point. I was in a dream-state. I had no idea why she was playing along, but when your cock is as hard as mine was, it wasn't the sort of thing you could sort out anyway.

I was imagining Daryl's cum streaking her body. Maybe she had reclined just like she was now, that sassy, defiant look on her face. Maybe she had smiled just like she was smiling now, with her mouth open to catch a thread of his seed.

A drop of precum gushed from the tip of my cock.

“What do you think I should have done?” she challenged me.

I climbed onto the bed in one movement and pushed my cock into her mouth. I pushed her head down the length of my shaft, and she opened up for me, taking it all in.

She even lifted her eyes and met mine. It seemed to me she was still smiling wickedly.

I pushed on her head, the way Daryl had in my fantasy, and my balls met her lips. I felt her gag around me, and I released her head. She flopped back on the bed, gasping for air. Her mouth was wet with spit, and her hair spilled out behind her, slightly rumpled where I had held her firmly against my cock. She gave me her smile: an invitation, a challenge, a...I didn't know what.

I put my hands on her ankles, and pushed her legs up so that her ankles were by her ears, exactly as I had imagined Daryl doing. I thrust my cock deep inside her wet cunt.

I had plans to fuck her deep and hard and pull out, the way I had imagined Daryl doing in my fantasy. Jerking my cum off all over her tits. But I was already too far gone for that, and I barely had time to thrust a few times before I groaned and came inside of her.

She clutched my ass, and ground herself against me. My cock was aching and it was almost too much to take, but I let her slam her body against me until she came. Her feet were bobbing on my shoulders, and her eyes were closed.

And the whole time, I was imagining that the sloshiness of her full pussy was another man's cum, and that her eyes were closed to imagine that she was fucking him instead of her husband.

She came and dug her fingernails into my back. "Fuck!" she said.

She thrust herself up, bucking against me wildly. Her pussy squeezed around my throbbing shaft, and she filled with so much wetness I could feel it smearing on my balls, dribbling down to her ass, surely.

She let her legs part and flop to the side, and we looked at each other, panting with the exertion.

There was an intense moment, and then Zoe brought her hand to her mouth. She gave a slightly awed laugh. "Oh my god," she said.

What she meant by that was, *oh my god, that's the hottest sex we've had in a long time*. Because it was. Even that weekend, on our getaway, it had felt almost like an obligation. A chore that neither one of us were particularly into. I mean – I was into it, of course I was into it – but it was all a little rote. Some kissing, some fondling, some not particularly passionate fondling. Zoe coaxing my cock into a state of readiness with her hand. Rolling over, missionary style, each of us in our own minds just a little more than we probably wanted to believe. Sure, sometimes a bottle of wine might bring out some dirty talk. But that was basically how it went these days.

This, though. This was different.

"That was really hot." Zoe surprised me by taking the words right out of my mouth.

I nodded.

There was a pause. Something was nagging at me. I had that sleepy feeling that overtook me every time I had sex, and it was worse when it was great sex.

Oh yes. I remembered what was itching at the back of my mind, and it shook me wide awake.

“So...what got into you?” I said, trying to sound casual.

Zoe let her arms float up above her and played with her hands. She turned to me and smiled. “What do you mean?”

I turned back at the ceiling and sighed. This made Zoe laugh, because she loved exasperating me.

Don't get me wrong. I loved Zoe exasperating me as well, or I wouldn't have married her.

“Have you been getting into my porn?” I said, turning on her suddenly and propping myself up on my elbow. The question just came out. I had taken great pains to hide my porn, because up until today I had thought of my fantasy as insane, and I had wanted to keep it secret. Very secret. But at this particular moment an urge to just...ask about it, get it all out on the table...overtook me.

“You...watch porn?” Zoe said, grinning, and I felt a sudden regret. If she wasn't going to take it seriously, I wished I could retract the whole thing.

Fuck.

She softened her smile immediately. Maybe she read the panic on my face. “Okay. I have to admit. I...stumbled upon something.”

“When was this?”

She laughed. “Like two years ago.”

I raised my eyebrows.

“Yeah, and at first it seemed really crazy. Then I forgot about it. *Honestly.*” She added the last word in response to the skepticism on my face.

“And then,” she said sweetly, “I remembered it. And...I don't know. I just thought I'd play a little game. See if there was anything to it.”

I was staring at her. She smiled at me again and shrugged. “Seems like there is.”

Still staring. Still open-mouthed.

She mocked me, and I threw myself back on the pillow. I rubbed my face.

My stomach was twisting.

“The thing I'm surprised by,” she said, her hands back up in the air, “is that *I* liked it so much.”

My cock went from slightly limp to teenage-morning-hard-on in less than a second.

I was frozen. I wanted to find a way to move my arm and pinch myself. My chest felt like it was soaring and plummeting all at once. Was my wife actually saying this?

So, this wasn't really a moment I ever expected to have happen. I wasn't prepared for it. I had fantasized about it, sure, but my fantasy was usually the dirty stuff, the actual stuff.

Not a conversation about it. Which, I was thinking at the time, was probably necessary and, in retrospect, something I should have thought through. Instead, I was caught with pants down, my heart beating fast enough to give me a heart attack. Dumbstruck. Like a fucking idiot.

Say something.

I opened my mouth, and my throat was dry, so I just kind of squawked.

I felt Zoe's hair on my stomach. Silky, sliding over my abdomen and then swishing over my cock. Strands of it tickled my inner thigh. I looked down.

She was crawling into position, her mouth hovering over my hard cock. She reached forward and clasped her slender fingers around my shaft. I watched as she rubbed me, up and down, my foreskin rolling along the strained muscle. Over the tip of my cock, her eye met mine.

I am having an out of body experience, I concluded.

Zoe's lips were very close to the tip of my shaft. “In fact,” she said, “I had so much fun teasing you..” and here she paused to purse her lips together lightly, and blow on the wet tip of my cock. The cool air from her breath glided over the ridge of my glans, then bit at the crown, and then curled around and gave a feathery stroke to my shaft. I shuddered. “That I might just...” she licked the pearl of precum at the crown of my cock, and rubbed it into her lips, before she lowered her head. I felt her tongue across my balls – just a lick – and then she dragged the blade of her wet tongue over the length of my shaft. Her eyes met mine again. My stomach spasmed, out of my control. My cock would have been flailing wildly in the

air if not for her firm grip around my shaft. “I might just think of actually trying it.”

She moved her hand down, and then back up, pumping another bead of precum from my shaft.

“Oh god,” I said.

She climbed up toward me. She crouched over me, her pussy just inches from my cock. She dipped a hand between our legs and she cupped my balls and squeezed them lightly.

“Would you like that?” she said. “Would you like me to actually try it?”

“Fuck, Zoe...” I whispered. Her hand was on my shaft now, and she guided the tip of my cock to her pussy. She embedded the crown in the wet folds of her outer lips and rubbed it over her clit. My cock was screaming to be inside of her, but she would have none of it. Her grip was firm and she was pleasuring herself now.

“Maybe there's a certain kind of man you'd like me to try out?”

A montage of images flashed through my mind. There certainly was a certain type of man I wanted her try out, and Zoe had obviously been in my computer a great deal more than she was letting on. I envisioned a big, black cock plunging into Zoe pussy, just as she thrust herself onto my shaft. I was barely fully sheathed in her hot flesh when I came, so hard and suddenly it was almost frightening.

I looked up at Zoe as she rode my cock until she came. Her head was turned up at the ceiling, and the sweet pain of another fantasy was almost too much to bear: that she was thinking of the same thing I was while she tipped over the edge, and shuddered with a crushing orgasm.

So that was a good weekend.

The beginning of our little game.

SECOND BASE

By the time Gerald Dubois gets done talking to you, so the story goes, whatever legislation he's chatting about will have already been taken to and struck down by the Supreme Court.

This was nearly the case by the time Gerald Dubois got done talking to me on the Friday night of the Second Thing That Zoe Did. The afternoon rain had stopped and the sun had come out. Of course, the sun was half-setting, and my wife had sent me a string of text messages that I had answered curtly by half-pocket-dialing. My last transmission had been garbage.

Fortunately, I was married to a nice, smart woman who had figured out what my problem was. Her last messages, two minutes apart, read:

[Zoe]: *Gerry?*

[Zoe]: *I see.*

[Zoe]: *I will entertain myself. Get here soon.*

[illegible]

It was date night.

As much as I resented having to schedule time with my wife, that's the way things panned out these days. I hurried to catch a cab and typed to her:

[Me]: *Finally. On my way.*

I gave the cabbie instructions and leaned forward in the seat, the senseless way I do to urge cabs to go faster. It was nearly 8pm, and I was over an hour late at this point. I hated being late, and I especially hated missing time with Zoe on date night. It seemed like we waved at each other from across the kitchen table occasionally, but otherwise never even saw each other.

My phone rumbled next to my thigh.

[Zoe]: *No hurry. I've met a nice man named Max.
He's keeping me company.*

The same cool feeling that had overtaken me at the truck stop came back, settling right into my lower abdomen and freezing my whole lower body.

Well...most of it.

What the fuck, I asked my cock, *is with you?*

In my mind, all kinds of images of Zoe and some other man flashed like a film montage. I typed, shaking:

[Me]: *Oh yeah? Is he hot?*

I waited. Staring at my phone. Reading and re-reading Zoe's text. *A man named Max, a man named Max...* it was making me a little car sick. It's not a manly thing, I know, but I get motion sickness in vehicles.

The screen lit up and I felt like a teenager, breathless as I read her message.

[Zoe]: *Yes. And interesting.*

I smiled. Zoe and her funny little games. She was probably talking to a troll and he was probably boring her to death with “Tales of Sales” as she called it, which she couldn't stand.

But just as I was thinking this, smugly, the screen lit up again.

[Zoe]: *I actually haven't gotten around to telling him I'm married.*

I stared at the screen.

I pressed the phone against my lips, trying to think of a good answer.

Well.

Trying to *think*.

My cock was hard. The idea of Zoe sitting there and flirting while she waiting for me, or supposed to be waiting for me, was having a two-pronged effect on me. Naturally, it pissed me off a little.

But why, then, was my whole torso getting stirred up with an excitement I hadn't felt in a long time?

[Zoe]: *Photo attachment*

I smashed the link with my finger. What the fuck was she up to?

The photo was a selfie. My eyes went over my wife's face and body first. She had a new dress on, as far as I could tell. A yellow one, sort of mustard colored. Setting off her light, light mocha skin and her amber eyes. Her lips were red and she was smiling her secretive smile. She was practically winking at me through the photo. But more importantly, her yellow dress dipped low, low, and several vast inches of her bosom were in full, glorious view. And pressed up against a blue shirt, beneath which a clear musculature showed. The photo had the obvious approval of the smiling man, with his smug, rich-n-famous grin...a man...who...

"*Max Harris?*" I seethed aloud.

"He's a very shide player, if you ask me," the cabbie broke out, in his Pakistani accent. "I know dey all saying, Max Harris will change the deam, Max Harris will fix de shiddy lineup, bud I have to say, whad has Max Harris done for de deam lately?"

I looked up at the cabbie. For a brief moment, he had taken both of his hands off the wheel to emphasize his point.

His eyes caught mine in the mirror. "Why you dalking about Max Harris?" he said.

"Oh, he's just...having a drink with with my wife," I said, cheerily.

The cabbie's brow furrowed.

"Dat's good," he said finally. "Dat's a relief because for a moment der I was worried you were a really big fan, put my food in my mouth, man. One dime I had a runner, I said I didn't like the Red Sox or someding like dat, and did guy he runs oud de cab and gives me middle finger, yelling some shide about Red Sox rule." The cabbie shook his head. "Fifdy dollar fare." He finished off with something in another language.

"That's ridiculous," I said, numb. What the fuck was happening here?

"No," the cabbie said, clicking the meter. We had stopped in front of the Fishmonger, without me even realizing it. "*Foodballer* fans are ridiculous. Dat guy he would have chopped my head off if he wad a soccer fan." He laughed. "I come all dis way, get away from crazy terrorist

blowing dings up, and I get my head chopped off by some soccer hoodlums, how do you like dat?" He leaned back to smile at me and hold up a finger. "Dis is why I don't talk about soccer in my car. Thirteen fifty please."

I gave him a twenty and stepped out of the car.

Zoe, meanwhile, had sent another text.

[Zoe]: *Want to play another game?*

Game. Games. Zoe always wins games.

"No, I do not want to play a fucking game where my wife is flirting with a fucking baseball star." I seethed.

But I typed: "Yes"

I stared at the screen. A car honked at me. I was in the middle of an alley exit.

[Zoe]: *Okay then. Just take a seat and watch.*

I stared at the screen, waiting for more.

Watch what? Watch what, exactly?

Oh, the possibilities. The possibilities that I didn't even want to admit to myself were turning around in my mind, beneath the surface.

It perhaps fits to mention here that Zoe and I, after our adventures on the Western Slope, had never really hashed out any sort of agreement or plan. In fact, the next morning, in the light of day, it had all seemed like dirty talk that would never leave the bedroom. Like something that would come up only as a fantasy – and don't get me wrong, I liked the fantasy, I would have been content with that. Zoe hadn't brought it up, and so as time went by, I began to think that was all I would ever get out of her.

Still hot. Probably the safest bet.

And now *this*.

What was I supposed to do?

What was she going to do? Would she just flirt this time, like she did before? Or had she been serious with her dirty talk, and now she was going to take it all the way?

With...well, the very kind of man I had claimed I wanted her to try.

My heart was racing as I finally gave up on composing another text and went inside the Fishmonger.

No, I didn't have a reservation, I said shakily, my head spinning.

I mean, wait, maybe I did.

The reservation for Charles Grant?

The words felt like they weren't even coming out of my own mouth.

"You're late," the hostess said icily. "I've given your table away."

I'd sit at the bar, I think I said. And then I was on my way, through the aquariums full of lobsters and crabs, into the steamy bar, called the Humidor, which also smelled like a humidor because you used to be able to smoke cigars there. It was crowded. My eyes searched desperately for my wife.

I found Max Harris first. He was tucked away in a round booth at the back of the bar, his hand over the back of it, just above the bare, slender shoulders of my wife.

The yellow dress was hanging from barely visible threads from her shoulders, and the fabric sort of slouched down, covering only the minimal fraction of her nipples to be considered decent. If there was any explanation for how my wife ended up sitting at the end of Max Harris' booth, with his arm just above her shoulders and his dark, square jaw just inches from her face, his eyes directed right into the gap between her breasts, and his other hand sliding closer and closer to her on the table...it was the dress.

I was being slowly pushed, in my catatonic state, up against a wall at the other side of the bar, by the millennials who for some reason had felt free to take over the Humidor even though it had always been for folks my age. I let them edge me to a safe harbor, where a small ledge served as a drink rest for everyone who had to stand.

Like me. Standing and watching Max Harris lean in closer and closer to my wife.

A few words on Max Harris. He played a professional sport, so that gave him manly, gladiator-status right off the bat. Then there was also the fact that he was an incredible specimen of man without that status. His face radiated confidence and dominance. He was in razor ads for a reason. And his plump lips and solid steel biceps were right next to my wife.

At that very moment, Zoe's eyes fluttered up and she met my disbelieving stare for a brief second. Her face, which had just been bright and open, laughing at one of Max Harris' jokes, went to its coolest and most mysterious. The corner of her mouth tightened just enough to give me her

mysterious little grin. It seemed like a sweet eternity as our eyes met, and she shared her smile of secrets with me.

Then, just like that, she was back to her flirtatious self. She brought a hand up to the super-slim strap of her yellow dress and played with it with her fingertips. She tipped her head, and placed her hand in her thick hair. She was tilted toward Max now, smiling. They looked on the very verge of kissing.

Blood was pounding inside my ears. Maybe it was the music. I have no idea. I felt like I was watching everything through a fog.

I wondered how far she would take it. I wondered how far I wanted her to take it. I dedicated part of my mind to scanning through what I had said to her in the hotel room in Grand Junction, if I had conveyed exactly what I wanted her to do.

Did I even know what that was?

They were still just talking. But they were talking just inches from each other's mouths. What do people even say to each other at that point? It's all just babble. Pre-coital drivel, part of a game, while they circle in closer, and closer.

Max Harris pushed a strand of my wife's hair from her face.

My stomach lurched up, slamming against my heart.

I looked on the table in front of her. Her phone was right there. She seemed to have placed it there very deliberately. I could put an end to it with just a text message. My fingers were in my pocket, running over the smooth surface of my phone.

Instead of taking it out, though, I watched as Max's fingers slid along the collar of her dress. Along the smooth length of her skin, over the hill of her collar bone, down to the swell of her breasts, closer and closer to the patch of brown aureola that was barely hidden by her dress.

And Zoe. She just looked at him, and smiled.

I took the phone out of my pocket, and set it on the ledge.

Write something, I willed myself.

But my eyes were drawn back to the table, to the dark fingers that were sliding all over my wife's chest in gentle, provocative circles. Up they went, to the other side of the low collar, and under the strap on her right shoulder.

Write something.

But I was glued to the scene and couldn't make myself do it. I had never, ever in my life been as turned on as I was at that moment. The strap of Zoe's yellow dress slid off her right shoulder, and the whole loose front of it slid down, just centimeters, until it was all so precariously perched on the hill of her right breast that the slightest ripple in the air would send it cascading and revealing her hard nipple to the whole bar.

And then.

And then.

That Idris Elba-look-aliking baseball-playing ebony fuckhead? He leaned in, so smooth it was almost like it wasn't even happening, and placed his big lips on her shoulder. Where the strap had just been.

And Zoe?

She tipped her head back and laughed.

Write something.

She was shaking her head now.

Then I watched as she held up her left hand, and she moved the band with her thumb, almost seductively, so the small diamond rolled back and forth on her finger.

Max Harris was unimpressed by whatever she said along with this gesture. And why wouldn't he be? I'm sure he fucked other guys' wives all the time. He lifted his right hand, which was enormous, and touched his fingertips to Zoe's ringed finger. His mouth kept going with all his smooth talking.

I felt like I had been kicked in the stomach. I was pretty sure I was going to throw up.

But I just stood there, watching.

Max Harris's hand dropped down below the table.

Without being able to see it, I could see the slow motion of his bicep. It didn't take much imagination to figure out where his fingers were going. Sliding up and under the satin material of Zoe's yellow dress. Over her knee at first, making her skin dimple on the back of her thigh. Up further...and was my dear wife sitting like a lady, with her legs crossed? Or were Max Harris' fingers right now moving up the inside of her milky thigh? He was really moving in on her.

Zoe's lips parted. Her face was frozen in a distracted expression. The kind of expression one might get if she didn't want to make a scene in public place when a man's fingers brushed over her panties.

Is that what I was seeing?

They were negotiating something now. Negotiating something with their mouths very close together, and Max's hand moving in slow, rhythmic motions under the table, between her legs.

Okay. This was maybe too far.

But I stared for a moment longer. Maybe if I hadn't, the scene would have unfolded completely differently. And our marriage. But who knows? I lingered on the scene in front of me, because it was so exhilarating and sickening at the same time, and then I turned to grab my phone while moving my hand at the same time. My fingers bumped the phone, it fell to the floor, and for a nanosecond it was there, all in one piece. And then the long, spiky heel of a girl who looked about ten years too young to be in a bar covered it.

I heard the sickening crack over the music, over the voices. Or maybe I didn't. Maybe I just imagined it. It sounded like a spine snapping. Or at least the television version of that sound. I stared at my phone.

"Like," the girl actually said, straight away, "Oh god! Oh my god I'm so sorry!"

She leaned down to pick up the phone at the same time I did. Her blue eyes had the vacuousness of a thirteen-year old, and she batted them apologetically. "I think it's totally fucked," she said, and a wave of her colorful, fruity Martini splashed over the rim of her glass and onto my wrist.

"It's fine," I said, and my voice was hurried. I looked at the phone. The screen was, in her words, totally fucked.

I stood up and looked back at where I had last left my wife. My heart plummeted when I saw the booth.

Empty. Actually empty.

But Zoe's yellow dress stood out, and so did Max Harris' enormous, gorgeous head. They were walking behind the bar.

A group of guys slowed their progress. Fans. They were doing some kind of elaborate hand-slapping with Max.

Zoe's eyes drifted over to me.

Her smile. The little upturned smirk-ish thing again.

I looked down at the phone in my hand. Maybe that was a bad choice, but it's what I did. I tried to message her, with no idea what I was going to say.

But the cracked screen fucked everything. I looked up at Zoe.
She was typing on her phone.
I looked down.
My screen lit up.

[Zoe]: *I'm going for a drink at his place. Just a drink. You tell me when to stop.*

I looked up. Zoe was smiling at Harris, Harris slid his arms around her waist, they cut through the crowded bar with no difficulty, because people got out of Harris' way like rats feeling a ship.

I started acting like an idiot. I pushed through the crowd, which didn't part for me as it did for Harris. I knocked a drink out of someone's hand. I fished a twenty out and threw it at her, she called me a stupid fuck and her friend poured a splash of margarita on my shirt.

No matter. I kept on. It felt like an eternity as I slogged through the bar, in the direction of my wife and Max Harris.

Out the back, to the parking lot.

It was a hot night. An air conditioner hummed.

The lot was empty, but the sexy moan of an expensive car drew my eyes to the back exit, where a red and white bar was shuddering to a stop, erect, and a silver Audi was slipping away, into the alley.

And then they were gone.

"Fuck," I whispered.

I held my phone in my palm, and stabbed at the screen uselessly until the whole thing went blue and then green and then black.

Was this actually fucking happening?

I stumbled around in the parking lot, looking for our car – Zoe had driven here. I found it, fumbled with the keys. My mind was racing. I sat down in the passengers' seat, opened the glove box, and took out the emergency phone I had purchased, along with a container of gasoline, after our adventures in the wilds of Colorado.

Because that's the kind of guy I am.

And then I sat there, staring at it.

I could see that I was a man, holding a phone, sitting in a car, getting ready to call his wife and tell her not to sleep with a gorgeous, black, baseball star. I could see this with my eyes.

But overlaid on that vision was a loop, a constant replay, of Zoe's sexy little smile. Her eyes burning right through me. Her naughty invitation, and Harris' fingers sliding beneath the straps of her dress.

That fucking dress. She looked like she should be escorting a guy like Harris, in a dress like that.

And the images started to get more and more fantastical. More and more vivid. Lurid. Lewd.

There it was, at the bottom of it all, holding me hostage with the phone in my hand.

I sort of...well...

I sort of *wanted* her to do it.

And here was a beautiful out. This broken phone. Making the decision for me. It was like the universe was telling me there was no other decision to make. Nothing else to be done. Zoe had gone to Max Harris' "place" for a drink, and I just couldn't do anything about it. I couldn't stop it.

I just had to let it happen.

I closed my eyes.

Fuck. Fuck fuckity fuck fuck fuck.

But this was great, wasn't it?

I have never in my life felt more torn by two opposite desires. I opened the car door and leaned out, feeling certain I was going to puke. But I didn't.

I started the car.

The next thing I knew, I was parked on our street, staring at the empty sidewalk and the streetlights.

What the fuck have I done?

This was the first coherent thought I had, after I sat there in the car for I have no idea how long. For a while I was just numb. Sort of shocked into a pleasant state of nothingness.

And then my stomach reported back to me. It was cold and queasy again, and the sensation spread out to my chest, to my limbs, finally working its way into my mind. Like an ice pick. Sudden clarity cracked through my mind:

My wife is fucking another man right now.

And I had let her do it.

Visions of Zoe with Max Harris' dark hands on her body flooded my mind. One after another, merciless and relentless. His hands wrapped around her thigh, her hand wrapped around his cock. His big, thick, veined cock, that she could barely close her fingers around. Her mouth open with pleasure as he dove between her thighs and tasted her sweet nectar. Her fingers raking his muscled back as he hammered himself inside of her until her unfaithful pussy was overflowing with his cum.

The sickness in my stomach went to a new level, almost painful. But my cock was hard, and it throbbed just as much as my stomach hurt.

What the fuck had I done?

It's fine that it was a fantasy. I didn't even know why I fucking liked it so much. It hurt, but I liked the feeling as it spread all over me, thinking about Zoe and another man. The painful sweetness of jealousy, the mixture of rage and arousal.

But *why*?

And if I couldn't answer that question, then why the fuck had I let my wife just play it out, this fantasy?

Anger at Zoe percolated up inside of me, and I tried to feed it. I tried to make it Zoe's fault: she had instigated it, she had been the one to actually do it, she was the one who wore that fucking dress.

But the logic wouldn't hold.

I was the one who sat there and watched her. Didn't stop her. Didn't call her.

Still wasn't calling her.

I wiped my face. More images flitted around in my mind, every one of them leaving a bruise inside my chest.

What the fuck had I been thinking?

A busy-body old dotty of a neighbor passed me and gave me quite a look. I waved, half-heartedly.

"You okay?" she said, leaning closer.

I realized that I was sweating, that I must look like a drunk parked in my car. I rolled down the window so she could sniff the air, which she did. She frowned, evidently disappointed she couldn't call the cops on me. "You look sick," she said flatly.

"I am."

"Well," she snapped. "Get home then."

I waited for her to slink around the corner, and vaguely wondered what *she* was doing out this late, before I stumbled out of the car and into the house.

Another man with my wife. Another man probing the soft center of her, another man getting his cock soaked inside her tight cunt. Another man, with a bigger cock, stretching her open.

What would I do when she came home?

My heart was beating wildly, so hard that I could actually feel it against my chest. I paced the house. The kids were with Zoe's parents again. The place was empty and I was left alone with my thoughts and the twisting beast in my stomach for hours.

Hours later, I heard her footsteps up the front stairs.

I was still pacing, like a caged animal. I looked for the clock:
11:30pm.

Was that too late? Not late enough? I tried to calculate what she could have done in that time, but before I could figure it out, she was inside.

Zoe closed the door, using both of her hands and leaning against it. My eyes moved accusingly over her dress. It seemed all in place, not put on hastily. Her tits jiggled as she pulled one of her shoes off her foot, then the other.

Her hair was damp from the rain. Her skin was dotted by beads of moisture.

She met my eyes, and gave a small shake of her head. "Well, Mr. Radio Silence?"

My stomach felt like it was being wrung out. "Did you do it?" I whispered. "Really do it?"

Her eyes narrowed. "I sent you a text," she said.

"Did you," I said. I could barely talk. "My phone was broken."

Her mouth turned up on the right side, just a flicker, just a brief moment, before she raised her eyebrows and expressed shock.

I'm sure I saw this. Sure of it.

Or maybe not.

"Your phone broke," she said flatly.

I was torn in a hundred different directions at that moment. Did Zoe look scared? Had she fucked him or not? Had she wanted me to stop her?

She moved closer to me. “So you had no way to read my text,” she said.

I couldn't tell if she was teasing me now. I was moving my eyes over her skin, inhaling deeply to see if I could find a trace of another man's scent on her. I didn't know if I was hoping to find it or hoping not to.

She slid her thumb under the strap of her dress, and let the left strap fall to her arm. Then the right. The dress shifted, and her breasts peeked out further.

I couldn't tell if she was seducing me, teasing me, serious...what?

“So you had no way of stopping me,” she said, in a low voice.

As she said it, she stepped closer to me. Her breasts were just inches from my chest. I felt her hand on my thigh, then on my cock. Her face remained the same – impossible to read – but her eyes seemed to glint when she felt how hard I was. “And all this time, you've been wondering what I was doing.”

I exhaled. I grabbed her arm, losing control of myself a little. I clawed at the straps of her dress and pulled it down, unpeeling her like a fruit so that her breasts were exposed. “And what have you been doing, Zoe?”

My fingers were feeling over skin. Searching for something dried or sticky, again, not knowing if I really wanted to find it or not find it.

She closed her eyes when I moved my fingers over her nipples.

She tipped her head back, and I lowered my head to suck up one of her hardened, caramel drops. Her full breast was hot beneath my lips. Her chest was rising and falling with quick, excited breaths. I could smell her excitement, and I dug one hand under her skirt.

I shivered when I found her bare ass. She had no panties on. The inside of her thighs was smeared with something – either just her, or the cum of another man.

I pushed her backward, aiming for the couch, but she fell down on an ottoman and I yanked her by the ankles so that she was lying on her back with her legs spread and her wet cunt open where I could see it.

I dropped to my knees and began by kissing her knee. This drove her wild, even in the dullest sexual encounters between us, and it didn't fail now. Her body went stiff and I gave her knee one more pass with just my lips, before I moved down her thigh.

My skin felt like it was going to burst into flames, as I moved down her leg. My nose was ready to encounter some foreign smell – the acrid

scent of cum, a streak of it crusted against her skin. But the only thing I found was her own juices.

Still, I thought, they could have used a condom. Or maybe he fucked his cum into her mouth. Or maybe she let him fill her ass...

I pulled the lips of her pussy apart with my fingers. She was drenched, and the seeking, needing thing inside of me tried to find something foreign in her smell. Her clit, a small tidy button, was hard beneath my thumb as I brushed it. I delighted in the shiver of her body, and I extended my tongue to the center of it, pressing down to make her shudder in earnest. I heard her gasp, and a low moan emerged from her chest. She twisted slightly, and smeared my chin and cheek with her buttery, honey-flavored juices. I sucked her taste into my mouth, still seeking something different in the flavor. It was unknown to me what I wanted to find, but all I found was her.

I pressed my mouth to her, rubbing the blade of my tongue against her clit and feeling for some sign of betrayal: a scent, a taste, a piece of her flesh that was swollen or distended somehow. I dipped my tongue into her gushing hole, running over the edge of her entrance, plunging into the silky channel of her cunt. Nothing but Zoe, as I always found Zoe: just soaked.

I couldn't tell if I felt let down, or if I was relieved. I sealed my mouth against her cunt and looked up at her as I massaged her clit with my tongue. She lifted her head to look at me: the strain of doing so hardened her abdomen. Her stomach muscles rippled with the spasm of her approaching orgasm, and her thighs squeezed my shoulders and began to shake as she panted and squealed her way over the edge.

She threw her head back as she came, and the whole sodden flower of her cunt burst in my mouth.

She shook from head to toe, and I pulled away from her and turned her as I rose to my knees. Her dress was rumpled around her waist now, and a shred of the satin fabric fell over her ass. I pushed it away with one hand while I fumbled to release myself from my pants. By now my cock was near bursting.

I pushed her bottom wide open, and her red gash stared at me. She was so wet it was dripping down her legs. The color of her cunt caught my interest for a while: was she flushed with the abuse of another man's hard cock? Could that be the proof I was either looking for or hoping not to find? I looked at her ass: still tight and puckered.

But my cock could take no more. I guided the tip to her gushing hole and entered her. I glided inside of her with no effort, almost falling into her. My cock made a squelching sound as I thrust inside of her.

“Did you let him fuck you?” I found myself saying. “Like this?”

Zoe lifted her head and her hair fell like silk over her shoulders. She moaned in response, and squeezed my cock with her cunt. She pushed back against me, driving my cock deep inside of her.

I pounded her, forgetting all about my inquest. As my climax rose inside of me, I imagined that Zoe had done just that. I had the answer to my question about myself: as I looked down at my own cock pistoning inside of her, I vividly pictured a thicker, darker dick spreading her wide open and plunging into her until she screamed.

I grabbed her hips, and began to hammer into her. “Oh fuck,” I barely whispered. “I’m going to...come...”

But my seed was already exploding inside of her, and I yelled at the force of my orgasm.

Zoe pushed against me, bouncing on my cock until I felt her squeeze all around me, and her pussy was suddenly so full and wet that I felt lost inside of her flesh.

We collapsed on the floor, sweating and breathing too hard to speak for a moment.

I was stunned. Stunned by the force of my climax, stunned by everything that had happened. Stunned by the truth inside of myself.

And then the cold, jealous feeling began to creep all over me again. I turned to my wife.

She pushed her curtain of thick dark hair from her face. Her chest was bare, and her breasts were rising and falling with a light panting. Beads of sweat dotted her temple. She was looking in front of her, off in some other thoughts somewhere. When she realized I was staring at her, she turned to me.

Her face focused. All of her dreamy features sharpened, and her eyes twinkled. Her mouth twitched, The smile.

She leaned back on her hands.

It was another game of chicken, I could see. I could see now that perhaps that's what she was playing at. Did I let her keep her secret? Could

I live with only the proof that I had tasted in her cunt? Was that proof of anything at all?

She glanced at me, and looked down at her dress, and frowned. Then she smiled, rather wickedly. She had me cornered.

There were no real rules to this game. I didn't even know if we were playing a game. Maybe it was all in my imagination.

But I knew she wanted me to ask her. Ask her what she did.

She extended a foot to her purse, smiling that provocative little smile. She took out a container of Tic-Tacs after she dragged it toward her.

She popped one in her mouth and crunched on it.

Maybe the minty Tic-Tac had covered up her deceit, I thought.

She jiggled the box in my direction, the same little smile on her face. I shook my head.

"No?" she said, and dropped it into her purse.

We looked at each other.

Then we laughed.

She tossed her hair over her shoulder. She had an expectant look on her face.

"Oh fuck," I said finally. "Just tell me what happened."

She smiled. *I win*, her smile said. She pushed her hair up and away from her face, and with an expertise I will never understand, used a pen to get it into a bun. She fanned herself with her hand. "Well," she said, "I went back to Max's place with him..."

She looked at me. On her face was an expression of extreme pleasure. Whatever I looked like, however the jealousy was eating away at me, she liked it.

"And in the car he was really putting the moves on me..."

"How?" I practically snapped.

She shrugged, as if it were the most boring conversation in the world. "Oh, you know...his hand on my knee, moving his fingers up, trying to get under my skirt..."

I remembered, at that moment, that she had no panties on when she came home. My cock sputtered back to life. The ache began all over again.

I waited like a fucking dog for her next words. She leaned on the ottoman. She placed her chin on her hands, which were folded one over the other. Her eyes were lit up, and her mouth was in that vexing little grin.

“And so then we went inside...and he poured me a glass of wine, and we sat down on the couch...”

She let me sit there for a moment, filling in the rest of the story for myself, imagining how he took the wine glass from her hand, set it down. How he placed his big hand on her chin, and then moved his fingertips down to her dress collar, and then slipped them under, so smooth...

“And then...a bunch of his friends showed up and they started having a party.” Zoe smiled. She sat back on her hands again. “It was pretty fun, actually.”

My heart was going wild in my chest.

“I did a bad thing though.”

Even wilder. I'm sure I looked like I was losing it.

She pulled a pack of cigarettes out of her purse.

I threw myself onto the floor on my back, and Zoe laughed.

Then she stood up, pulling her mangled dress back on, and skipped into the kitchen. I heard the sliding door roll open. “Come on, join me,” she said.

“So your phone was really broken?” she said, waving the match in the air to put it out.

I watched her take a drag of her cigarette: a habit that I had fought hard to quit and found pretty disgusting for myself, but which Zoe always did in a way that made it seem clean and beautiful. She had this European style to her smoking, and when she exhaled she often made a little ring and watched it. She looked at it in a disconcerting mix of child-like wonder and femme-fatal enigma. She did this now, and I stared as the smoke curled out of her mouth.

I lit my own cigarette.

Fuck. Fuckity fuck fuck it was good.

I scowled.

“Yeah,” I answered. I looked at my wife. I had the answer to the question that was burning inside of me: I'd asked it and she'd answered it, and I'd found no evidence to the contrary. But I just couldn't help asking again: “So really, nothing happened?”

Zoe laughed. I was grateful to hear a dusting of patience in her laugh. A little like she was taking questions from a child, but that was better than me pissing her off. “I told you. The whole gang of friends just burst in. It's

kind of funny actually.” She laughed lightly and leaned on the railing. “It’s a good thing, I guess.”

“You guess.” I couldn’t keep a little bit of bitterness out of my voice. Though if you asked me to tell you what I was bitter about, I wouldn’t have been able to tell you.

Zoe responded to this by looking at me and then turning out toward the yard and blowing another tidy ring of smoke and watching it.

“I’m only doing this because you seem to like it,” she said finally.

I felt a flash of anger crawl over the back of my neck.

“Uh...that’s not exactly fair,” I said. It sounded kind of lame, and I knew the anger was evident in my voice.

Zoe turned to me. “Oh no?” She seemed more curious than anything else, which only pissed me off even more. How could she be so casual about this? And now she seemed like she didn’t care one way or the other about my answer, which was infuriating.

“You’re sort of shifting all the...you know, ‘vice-guilt’ onto me,” I said, looking out into the yard.

This was a common theme in our marriage. Zoe liked to implicitly blame a night of heavy drinking, or smoking a cigarette, or spending too much money, on me somehow. It got under my skin, because it took only a feathery breath to blow Zoe into drinking a whole bottle of wine on a school night, for one. And half the time, I couldn’t count on my own shitty memory to straighten out whose idea it had been. But I felt like I got a disproportionate amount of the blame. After all, Zoe wanted to do this stuff; she just didn’t want to be responsible for it.

“Ahhh,” Zoe said. “The old ‘vice-guilt.’”

I had no idea what she meant by saying this.

“Well...yeah,” I said defensively. I was getting pretty riled at this point. “You know, I was just minding my own business, keeping this a secret, watching my porn...You’re the one who started...*this*.”

Zoe blew another little ring of smoke into the sky.

And then the most amazing thing that has ever happened in our marriage – and I just mean, “surprisingly amazing,” (not to, you know, diminish the birth of our children or anything) - happened: my wife sucked her breath in, and said, “Yeah, okay. I guess you’re right.”

“I’m right,” I repeated.

Zoe smiled.

A momentous occasion. I had sworn that if this ever happened, I would dance a jig, but something felt unfinished and I wasn't as joyous as I thought I would be.

Because what was I right about? That my wife had instigated this whole “game” of flirting with other men. Getting me off on it. Getting herself off on it. Something was still bugging me about it. Some unfinished thought, or thing.

“Why the long face?” Zoe said. She leaned on her elbow and turned toward me, crossing one of her slender legs over the other. God, that fucking dress.

“Where'd you get that dress?” I said.

“Lord and Taylor or something. Don't change the subject.”

“It's hot.”

“Stay on target.”

I exhaled and looked away. “I don't know. Something's still bugging me.”

“About this.”

“Yeah.”

Zoe blew another ring of smoke. “You had one more question about it,” she said. Her voice was almost hypnotic.

I did. But what was it?

What was bothering me so much?

Ah, yes.

“What would you have done,” I said, “If those guys hadn't showed up.”

Zoe pointed her cigarette a little at me, and gave a very slight jab in my direction as she exhaled, and recaptured some of the smoke in her mouth. Her lips were doing an elaborate, sexy dance in the air for a moment. “That's the question,” she said.

“And?”

“Well, what would you have wanted me to do?” She leaned on both of her elbows. She was amused. We were in another Mexican standoff. This time, it was about who would reveal the truth first.

The problem was, I just had a big question mark at the back of my mind. And I hated that Zoe seemed to have a real answer. As if she'd already given all of this a ton of thought, and decided that she just wanted to do it.

There it was. There was the thing that was bothering me.

“So I have a problem,” I said to Zoe's amused face.

Her face was bright with the look she gets when she already has something figured out. I ignored it.

“I don't know what I want you to do.”

She pressed her lips together. She looked like someone who was about to check-mate you in a game of chess.

“And that, my dear Charles, is why...I didn't do it.” She smiled. “I wouldn't have done it,” she added quickly.

I felt a huge swelling of tenderness for her at that moment. And relief.

And still...it just wasn't...exactly what I wanted.

I sighed audibly and leaned my head back. My cigarette was out and she offered me another one.

I took it, telling myself I deserved it because I was stressed out.

Zoe turned to me and put her hand on her hip. “Hold on,” she said.

She was smiling, her lips pressed together. “What about your other phone?”

The other phone.

Ah, the truth *will* out, will it not?

I scratched my forehead with the back of my thumb and squinted. It was a universal tell. I could not play poker, or negotiate the sale of a used car, to save my life.

Zoe needed nothing more than that. “Huh,” she harrumphed, and her voice almost sounded impressed.

She blew another ring of smoke. “I guess *you* win,” she said softly, with a little smile on her face.

I rubbed harder and took a drag of my cigarette.

“Okay, Zo, don't get me wrong, this little...game you're playing is really fucking hot...but...”

She pushed away from the railing and caught herself with her hands so she didn't fall backwards. She playfully rocked back and forth, and raised her eyebrows expectantly.

Then she dropped to her heels. “You're the one who didn't call, Chaz.”

I stared at her. “What's gotten into you?” I said.

She shook her head. “I don't know.”

“Are you really just doing this for me?”

There it was, the real question.

She looked at me archly. “Truth?”

“Truth.”

She looked at her hands. “Okay, it started that way. But then..I don't know. It was kind of fun. It was fun getting some attention that was...I don't know. Different.”

“But do you want to take it all the way? Would you?” My voice was a little too edgy. Too hungry. I tried to control myself, rein myself back in, but I could feel that I had the beady eyes of a man who *needed* something. I hated the feeling. I hated needing things from Zoe. Needing her attention, needing her body, needing her to say something right at his moment that was what I wanted to hear, when I didn't even know what that was myself.

Zoe shrugged, and my head nearly exploded. *Shrugged*. It was just like that for her. *Shrug*. Sleep with another man, *shrug*.

“I don't know,” she said, before my mind went completely berserk. “I mean...it seems like it might be a good idea. It turns us both on so much, right?”

I couldn't deny that. So I stared at her.

“But then...like, it's such a big thing to do...you can never take it back, you know? So...”

There was a long, long pause here. I was waiting for her next words with such intensity that I was grinding my teeth together.

“I guess...I just don't know either.”

We both leaned on the railing and looked out into the yard.

“Well,” Zoe said after a few minutes of silence. “That was a lot of talking to get nowhere.”

“I dunno,” I said.

“I dunno,” she repeated.

An oft-repeated joke. An oft-repeated scenario: lots of talking and no conclusion.

Except usually it was about something less...well, explosive. Or exciting. Something like whether to save X amount of dollars or Y amount. What to do about Annie biting her nails or Jimmy being an asshole at soccer practice.

“Let's sleep on it?” she said.

We kissed.

I know it seems weird, but at that moment, when I met her eyes and our lips were pressed together, I felt closer to my wife than I had for a long time. I know it seems crazy in the context of talking about her fucking

another man. I know. But it really seemed to be true, all the things they said on message boards and communities on the internet: there was something about the danger and the risk of it all, that seemed to bring us back into each other's orbits the way nothing ever seemed to be able to do.

We were there for a while, I don't know how long.

"I still have his number," Zoe said at some point, and something hot flickered inside my abdomen.

I won't lie that after that night I was dying to bring it up again. We slept on it and then I waited like a salivating dog for Zoe to say something about Max Harris. Or to start another round of flirting.

But I had my dignity. If she wasn't going to bring it up, I wasn't going to go around desperately asking her.

And that was the second part of our little game. That's all there really was.

For then...

THIRD BASE

Zoe was wearing a white dress. It was, without a doubt, the most stunning thing I had ever seen on her. There was really nothing to it, in the sense that there wasn't anything particularly special about it. It was a simple fabric, plain white, short and dipping low, hugging her figure tightly. Her legs dangled out of it, all the way to the floor, a line of silky-smooth, light-olive skin. Her breasts plumped out the top of the dress, two perfect spheres with a deep valley between them. She was wearing very high heels. Her hair was down and shimmered in the red and green lights that had begun to swirl and flash when I walked into the room. I kept my eyes on her, and her mouth moved to form some words I could barely make out. She was shaking her head slightly, like she didn't want me to notice.

It wasn't my idea.

That's what she was saying.

I kept my eyes on her so I wouldn't pass the fuck out.

Nothing quite made any sense for a few minutes. I looked around the room, at the faces staring at me. Zoe was the only one with a recognizable expression. Her chin was tilted up slightly, her mouth tipped upward in one corner, a small flicker of amusement running through her mind. But in a way she was scowling, which is something I love her for. She had her arms folded and glass of champagne suspended by her fingertips.

The rest of the faces were in state of crazed animation. They were all talking. The clatter coming from their mouths was incomprehensible. My stomach was plummeting to the other side of the world. Passing right through the center of the earth, right now, still reporting back to me like the opening scene of *Indiana Jones and The Temple of Doom*, when the guy's heart gets ripped out and starts burning when he's lowered into the fire pit.

I blinked.

I stared.

This was the worst of all possible worlds.

“Happy Birthday!” someone shrieked again, right in my ear.

Confetti – really, confetti? - burst around me in the air. There was a cake with many, many candles on it.

I forced a smile. I looked to Zoe for strength and she mouthed: *sorry*.

I had issued an edict, a long time ago, to everyone I knew: No surprise parties. *Ever*.

I looked around for the guilty party. None of my guy friends would have done it. No way.

Adam? I looked at my brother. He seemed amused as he lifted a glass to toast me, but amused in a detached way, like he hadn't done it but he hadn't done anything to stop it. Sort of like Zoe looked, as a matter of fact.

And then there she was. My kid sister. Beaming.

"It's great, Kate," I said. What else can you do? She did a little dance with her feet and gave me a bear-hug.

She was twenty-five. A word people frequently used to describe her was "chipper."

Zoe slinked through the crowd and stood next to me. She handed me a beer.

"Tell me this isn't what you meant by, 'I have a surprise for your birthday,'" I said.

Zoe just laughed and tipped her beer into her mouth. "I'm sorry. You know how Kate is."

I had been looking forward to my birthday since Zoe had dropped the hint that she had a surprise. I had been so caught up in my twisted fantasies about that surprise, and my paranoia, and my angst, that I hadn't even seen Kate planning this party right under my nose.

Zoe turned to me. "I'll make it up to you," she whispered. "Just try to have fun."

So I did my best.

The party went on and on, until finally everyone had had enough of congratulating me for being old or telling me it was not that bad. We climbed into a cab and I leaned my head back on the seat. I had caught quite a buzz, and so had Zoe. In truth, I'm sort of introverted, and I just wanted to go home and eat a sandwich in front of the TV.

Zoe's phone buzzed.

She fetched it from her tiny purse, and smiled when she read the screen.

Then she dropped it back into her bag.

But she had that smile on her face.

"What?" I said.

She shook her head. "Oh it's just..." she sat back. "Nothing."

"What?" I repeated.

"Oh, just...you know...Max."

"He's *texting you*?" I said.

Zoe smiled and held up her watchless wrist to tap on her skin. "Seems like a booty call to me," she said.

Then her eyes dropped to my pants.

She leaned over and placed her hand on my thigh, moving down to my hard cock as she did. "Don't worry," she said. "I'll tell him it's your birthday and I just *can't* get away."

My mind was still in loop, replaying the words "booty call" over and over.

She teased me a little, her mouth just inches from mine. My cock twitched and she smiled.

She looked at the cabbie in the mirror, and then I felt her hand on the buckle of my belt. She brought her fingers to her lips to hush me, and I stared as she unbuckled me and deftly undid my pants and zipper. Her hand plunged into my shorts and closed around my cock.

She took her phone out with her other hand. She was massaging me now.

She showed me the screen.

[MH]: *Whats my little mommy up to tonight?*

Zoe grinned when my cock throbbed in her hand. She typed, her left hand working magic on my cock, her right hand working magic on her phone.

[Me]: *I'm free*

She let her thumb hover over the send button, and looked at me. Her free hand was moving over my cock and I really could barely breathe. I was rising up to a high I'd never experienced before.

I believe that I nodded. Whatever I did, my eyes moving wildly, my cock gushing precum, Zoe gave me one last second to change my mind. Her mysterious little smile seemed to invite me in, she almost seemed to wink at me.

“Wait,” she said, suddenly. She gave me her most wicked smile, and turned so that she could look up at me. “Should we do something extra-naughty? For your birthday?”

I don't know what I did. Probably I just watched her, open-mouthed.

She sat up a little straighter, and began to do something I had a great deal of time understanding until it was done. I watched her as she pulled her skirt up a little, held her phone away from her body and then closer, frowned, looked at something, adjusted herself in her seat...I was zoned out. Images of Max Harris sitting somewhere in the city, his cock getting a little tingly and making him think of my wife – *my* wife – and the idea occurring to him to take out his phone and type to her. *My little mommy*. The implicit possession of the word “my” gripped me in its hot paw, squeezing on my chest.

I was so involved in this that Zoe had held up the phone for a full minute before I snapped out of it.

“Too much?” she said, to my silence.

I shook myself back into the cab. I looked at the phone.

She had taken a picture – a pretty good one, too – up her skirt. It was a nice shot that revealed her inner thigh, her white thong, the soft swell of her mound straining against the fabric. Very faintly, the shape of her lips outlined beneath the sheer material.

My cock answered for me, hardening even more, although I never would have thought it was possible. Zoe smiled, and I watched her fingers as she added the photo to her messenger. “Chucky likes it,” she said. Her finger paused over the send button.

She leaned against me, and her hair was just below my nose. I inhaled the scent of her. She looked up at me. “So?”

There wasn't much going back after this, we both knew. This was kind of “it.” Do it, or don't do it. Put it off, and have it hanging over us forever, the possibility, the angst.

“Do it,” I breathed.

And the picture went off into cyberspace.

I had that feeling, like I was falling off a cliff. The feeling you get when something in your life goes: pop! And it's just...done. You can't do anything to turn it around.

I looked at Zoe. She seemed excited. She was stroking my cock, but her eyes had gone all dreamy and I could tell she was thinking ahead.

There was still a way out, I reassured myself. She didn't have to hook up with him.

I imagined Max out there somewhere. Looking at my wife's panties, nestled between her thighs. I imagined the excitement he felt, thinking about how he was going to get inside of her tonight. It was so obvious. A real home run. He could probably already feel it, as he took his next swing. He said that kind of shit on sports shows all the time. He knew where the ball was going mid-swing. He felt it, before they cracked together. I bet he could feel it now. Right now, while he looked at the delicious inner thighs of his “mommy.”

Zoe's phone buzzed in her hand. My cock twitched in anticipation.

[MH]: *That's hot. A little tame for a Friday though.*

Zoe looked up at me. She already had the idea I wanted her to have. I stroked her hair, and she grinned as she pulled her hand from inside my pants. She moved to the other side of the cab. She paused when the cabbie's eyes followed her, his brow furrowed in suspicion. She began to rock back and forth as her fingers worked her panties out from beneath her skirt. I watched them drop to her ankles. Her high heels slipped out of their bondage, first one, then the other. She picked them up and tossed them at me. They were damp. She was already so excited.

I watched as she leaned against the door, turning sideways, and smiling at the cabbie when he looked back at her.

She tossed the phone to me.

Then she spread her legs open. Slowly, teasing me. Until there was a lovely view of her long legs, spread open, the white dress hiked up to her thighs. Her feet were akimbo, like a fashion-model's, and between her thighs her glistening pussy was dripping open. The red of her gash appeared ready to burst out. I took the picture, forgetting to turn off the flash.

“Ay, man! Jesus!” the cabbie shouted. “You cannot take a picture in my cab!”

“I'm so sorry,” Zoe said, giggling.

“It's very very dangerous,” the cabbie rattled on.

Zoe held the back of her hand to her nose to keep from bursting out laughing. She slid back toward me, and cuddled up on my shoulder. She

leaned in to see the picture.

With the flash, it was sort of lewd and filthy. She frowned.

"It's perfect," I assured her: and it was. The flash highlighted the droplets of excitement that dotted her outer lips, the slick wetness of her inner folds. It gave the scene a very lurid quality, but it was all the more appealing because of that. Almost like the paparazzi had gotten to her.

She attached it and sent it. Then she covered her mouth with the top of her hand and snorted. "I can't believe I just did that."

I couldn't either, but I was so excited by now that I could barely speak.

The cab rolled up to the side of the street. We were home.

Zoe sat up straight and leaned forward. "I'm so sorry," she said. "We have to go back downtown again."

I could see that the cabbie was no idiot: he knew something was going on in the back of the car. My wife's honeyed scent filled the air, for one thing. Our giggling probably didn't hide things very well, either.

He shrugged though. A fare was a fare. More crazy people going all over town.

"Do me a favor," he said. "I am a very paranoid man. Please pay for this fare and I will ring in a new one."

Zoe slipped two hundred-dollar bills through the hole in the window. "That should take care of it. You give me the change when we get back."

I had a brief thought about asking my wife where she got \$200 cash and why, but as the cab rolled into the street and Zoe's hand moved back up my thigh to my cock, I forgot all about it.

We waited, both of us grinning with closed mouths, like teenagers up to no good, in the back of the car.

It seemed like an eternity before her phone buzzed again.

She lifted it, read the message, and smiled. Her pinky finger was sliding up and down my shaft over the material of my boxers. I was still unzipped, lewd as fuck in the back of this cab. I didn't care.

She flipped the phone so I could see the screen.

[MH]: *That isn't you*

The words, and the response they begged for, hot me as though I ran straight into a wall. I looked around, half expecting to see that we had just

crashed into a tree. The whole world seemed to shift.

“Tell him,” I whispered, and I had to swallow to get the cottony-dryness out of my throat, “tell him you’ll show him in person.”

This was it. I had just given my wife permission to go all the way. Instructions, even.

Zoe stayed calm. Cool as a cucumber. She grinned her little grin, and held the phone to her chest for a moment, looking up at the roof of the cab. “I can do better than that,” she mused. “I think we need to tease him a little more.”

Tease him? Or tease me?

Who knew?

Who cared?

Zoe typed. She flipped the screen to show me.

[Me]: *Ha. Who is it, then*

We waited.

[MH]: *How do I know you didn’t steal that pic off the internet?*

Zoe looked at me, and then she got a wicked little grin on her face. She leaned up and whispered her plan to me in my ear. Her breath sent electricity rippling down the side of my neck. My heart overturned, my stomach twisted, my cock pulsed until I could feel a huge glob of precum staining my boxers.

Zoe typed, my implicit approval conveyed by my panting silence.

I watched the letters appear, one by one, each one slicing through me with the most pleasantly painful ache I had ever experienced.

[Me]: *Give me something to do, and Ill do it*

I could barely feel my arms and legs. I was pretty sure my cock had robbed my whole body of any feeling. I could hardly breathe. My chest felt like an elephant was sitting on it as we waited. Beats of silence. The road outside was slick with rain. I hadn’t even noticed that it had rained. The cabbie was keeping his eyes rigidly on the road.

The phone buzzed.

[MH]: *MayB if I saw ur hands n there. I n ur clit.
I inside.*

It was so lewd. So lewd that someone was typing this somewhere.
And even lewder that my wife was going to do it. In a cab.

And I was probably going to take the picture.

Her phone buzzed again.

[MH]: *Or just show ur pretty face.*

Zoe laughed and typed:

[Me]: *no fucking way I'm doing that*

“Okay,” she said. She placed the phone in my hands, and I read her last message to Max. Even though my head was spinning, I was silently grateful that my wife had enough sense to keep her face out of her nude pictures. I myself hadn't even thought of all the terrible possibilities of her sending a picture with her face.

She leaned back on the door again, and placed one foot on the floor and the other on the seat. Her white heels gave a jagged, high-fashion end to her thighs, and she pulled her skirt up just enough to see her red cunt, and I noted with satisfaction and a bit of pain that she was even more excited than before. She made a v-shape with two of her fingers and rubbed the fingertip of her forefinger over her clit while she dipped her middle finger into her hole.

I was staring, having completely forgotten to work the phone. The cabbie, I knew, *had* to be able to hear the faint stickiness of her cunt. Surely he could smell what I could smell, the scent of her pussy, the excitement of sex coming on.

I fumbled with the phone while Zoe grinned at me.

“No flash,” she mouthed, just before I took the picture.

The cabbie turned up the music.

We hit a bump and the picture I snapped blurred, which made Zoe laugh. She steadied herself on the seatback and got into position again.

The photo was pretty poor quality. The flash looked a lot better.
I handed the phone to Zoe.

“You sending it like that?” I said.

She grinned at me. “It's good enough. It's actually better this way.”
She bit her lip and sent the photo, then reached across the seat to snatch her panties from my hand. She wiggled into them while grinning at me.

“Where are we going to?” the cabbie said, sensing a moment to ask us the question.

“Uh...” Zoe said. “Take us to First and Seneca.”

We waited.

She held the phone up for me to see when the next message came in.

[MH]: *Bad quality*

Zoe typed.

[Me]: *I'm in a cab. It's the best I cld do ;)*

I sucked in my breath. Once more the reality of what was going on floated through the fantastical mist that had enveloped me: somewhere in the city, a major-league baseball player was opening files on his phone of my wife's fingers playing with her cunt. He was getting turned on by them. Planning his moves. Thinking he would get inside of her before the evening was over.

The cabbie was impatient.

“Keep the change,” Zoe said, without even asking him how much it was. She opened the door and stepped out of the cab.

The street was lively and people were already good and drunk by then. A couple of guys whistled as Zoe stepped out of the car. I hopped around to the sidewalk. My erection was embarrassingly prominent, and I was glad to have a jacket to hold in front of my pants.

Zoe gave a toss of her hair. The rain was evaporating in the hot air, but the electric light of the bars was still pooling in the wet streets. Voices echoed off the concrete, a light breeze mingled with the light-green evening and the inky sky. “So?” she said.

This was, “so, do you want to go through with it?” I knew it.

But my chest was being clutched by the two feelings inside of me, and I had no idea what to say.

She looked at her phone.

“It's him. He wants to meet at his place.”

I found my voice. “Tell him no. Tell him...meet you at a bar or something.”

Zoe raised her eyebrows.

I wanted more time. I wanted to watch a little longer. I wanted to make sure this was the decision I wanted to make.

Zoe stepped toward me. She put her hands over my shoulders. “You didn't think I wouldn't find a way for you to watch, did you?”

I gave in to my “hopeless schtick.” “I don't...I don't know,” I said.

Zoe stepped back and cocked her head. She was thinking. Her hands were still on my shoulders. Then she smiled her mysterious smile again and typed away on her phone.

This was an awkward moment. She was typing forever. She typed and smiled, typed and smiled, and when I tried to edge myself in to peek at what she was typing she held her hand up and pushed me away. “Don't look. It's a surprise.”

I felt pretty certain I'd had enough of surprises for the night.

Or had I?

I watched as my wife typed, her face lit up a little by the screen, her eyes moving as fast as her fingers. She was biting her lower lip, and grinning.

And I was standing there on the sidewalk, with the most painfully hard erection I had ever had in my life, growing impatient and sick to my stomach and even more turned on with every passing second.

Zoe sucked in her breath. She held up the phone, and I glimpsed a long paragraph that she hadn't sent. She waved it casually in the air and looked at me. “Now what I need to know from you is: are you really up for this?”

This.

I must have paused a long time.

“Come on,” Zoe said. “It's your birthday. Live a little.”

I gave a very small nod. Her finger pressed against the screen, and whatever it was seemed to be done.

“Okay,” she said, leaning forward and placing her hand on my chest. “I have a few things to do. These guys want to meet me at the *Corral*. You know it?”

“The strip club?” I said, incredulously.

Zoe waved her hand in the air. “I know. Super trashy, but it's where they want to meet.”

“They?” I said.

She grinned. “He has a few friends with him. You know...entourage.”

I started to shake my head. This was all seeming a bit...too much. An entourage? What the hell was Zoe getting into? What were *we* getting into? This whole thing was gaining a dark momentum that threatened to dwarf my control – and hers. The excitement began to be eclipsed by a pooling fear that perhaps we were in way over our heads...

Zoe placed her hands on my shoulders again. “Look,” she said. “I've just planned the *best* birthday party for you ever. And all you have to do is go to the *Corral*, watch some of the girls for a bit, and then wait for your party to start.”

I didn't feel 100% on board with this.

“Uh...Zoe...I don't know,” I said. “This is getting kind of...”

Her hand slid down my chest and found my cock. She squeezed me over my pants. “You'll just have to trust me. Now, do you want me to give you a five-star performance tonight, or do you just want to go home and watch TV?”

I was proud of myself for managing to exude a tiny bit of humor when I said: “Uh...why do those have to be the only choices?”

But my cock was pulsing beneath her palm, and so whatever I might have been trying to convince her, or myself, of, there was really no lying about what I wanted.

“Couldn't we just take it down a notch?” I breathed. “This seems a little...much.”

Zoe pushed away and tossed her hair. “It's now or never,” she said, smiling. “Guys like Max Harris aren't going to let a woman tease him forever.”

She was stepping back slowly. Her heels clicked on the pavement. She was biting her lip, baiting me, trying to get me to think of all the things that had happened, just now, and all the possibilities for this evening.

Now or never. Now or never.

“I’ll see you at the *Corral*, then?” she said.

“But...what...?”

She spun around, stepping forward and then spinning around in a full circle. “I have to do some things. So see you in half an hour? No? Yes?”

I stared at her.

“Okay...I’m going...”

And she turned around and practically skipped down the street.

Every head on the street turned for her. I knew it was more than just the fact that she looked great. Every girl on the street looked great that night. There were all kinds of hot little numbers holding hands and giggling as they walked down the street. But Zoe was radiating something else. A determined, confident sexual energy. And it was drawing every eye to her like a magnet.

I just watched her go. It felt like I might be trying to stop the wind to do otherwise.

And not only that, half of me was already in *Corral*, waiting for my second surprise party to start.

She turned the corner and smiled at me as she did.

I turned on my heel, and started to walk the five blocks to *The Corral*.

Confession:

I had only been to a strip club one other time, almost fifteen years ago, for my twenty-first birthday. It was the last stop on a round of bars that my older brother had dragged me to, and by that time I really couldn't see straight. But as I walked into the *Corral*, I realized that the club I had been to was the *Corral's* predecessor, and not much had changed with the new ownership.

A mild rush of discomfort came over me. Two girls were on the stage dancing, and they caught my interest for a while with their very acrobatic feats. “Huh,” I said, sitting down. People really didn't give strippers as much athletic credit as they deserved. One of the girls was spinning round and round with her legs hooked on the pole. It was really something. She was a scrawny girl, and her tits were obviously fake, so not my type at all. But you had to admit, she was a talented pole-dancer.

I ordered a drink from a very young, very friendly girl, who insisted I take the top-shelf liquor and convinced me quite easily. She was wearing a

deep-cutting black sequined “suit” that looked more like a bathing suit, and she filled it out nicely.

And then I saw *them*. There was a VIP section at the *Corral*, cordoned off by a fuzzy red rope and everything. It was gaudy, red-velvet covered affair up there, with mirrors on the ceiling and a nice close view of the dance floor. A few strippers were stretched out on the couches, sipping champagne and flipping their hair, lounging around with Max Harris, some guy I knew to be an ex-teammate, and some other hulky-looking men who were probably baseball players as well. They were all dressed in expensive-looking suits, all looking every part the athlete, and waving money around at the girls like it was confetti.

I slammed my drink.

Max was on his phone. I felt a rush as he smiled at whatever he was typing. It had to be Zoe he was talking to.

Then I went cold. Had he been here the whole time? Had he been showing Zoe's pictures to his buddies? Was that whole VIP section of professional athletes checking out my wife's cunt?

“Another one?”

The waitress, who could not have been more than five feet tall and sixty pounds, had a pipsqueak voice that was coming through to me as a deep baritone. My blood pressure was actually that high, it was distorting the sound of the entire club.

I stared at her.

“Another vodka soda?” she said.

I nodded and turned back to the gang of guys in the VIP room.

I took out my phone and typed to Zoe.

[Me]: *You know there are a ton of guys here*

I wasn't even sure what I meant by that. My finger hovered over the “send” button.

What was I doing? She knew. She had told me as much.

They were laughing now. Were they laughing at something Zoe had sent them? Were they laughing at me, the poor sap whose wife was going to fuck them all at a trashy strip club?

She wouldn't.

I tried to calm myself down. I could hear Zoe's voice telling me to trust her. I set the phone down without sending the message. My stomach was writhing inside of me.

I sat there for what seemed like an eternity and no time at all, racked straight through with pain and excitement.

It might be false to claim this, but this is how it seemed to happen to me: when Zoe appeared in the club, the entire atmosphere changed. It was as if a ripple, like the aftershock of a bomb, traveled through the room.

Maybe that didn't actually happen. Maybe I just imagine these things. But I remember watching the men turn and look at her, feeling the excitement rise in the air, and wondering: who was this woman I had married?

Had our whole marriage gone on, all this time, with me just having no clue about the woman I had married? I knew Zoe was attractive. I knew she was way more attractive than I deserved. And I had appreciated that fact for the two years we had dated, and then I had appreciated it for a while after we got married.

But then what had happened?

I realized it all as I watched her walking across the room, headed straight for the VIP room: I had gotten complacent. Maybe having a wife as good-looking as Zoe had filled my head with nonsense, made me feel entitled. Maybe the saying is true: when you don't remind a woman of her beauty, she forgets it.

Maybe, I concluded, I was just a fucking idiot.

Whatever it was, I could see that I had really been playing with fire all this time. And now, my wife was dressed to kill in that white dress, and she was standing in front of the VIP lounge at the *Corral*, about to sit down with Max Harris and his friends. *That* was the woman I had married. It was all on the line now. I had to just hope that she was going to stay mine, even after she had a glass of champagne and Max slid his huge, strong hands up under the white fabric of her skirt.

I felt sick.

The waitress was back. I was burning through cash I didn't have, but I didn't care. I ordered another drink because I had no idea what else to do. The first two hadn't even gone to my head. They were probably water.

Zoe was behind the red velvet rope now.

Max was stretched out on the couch, his arms across the back of it and his tree-trunk legs open. Taking up as much space as possible. The Alpha Male. His eyes were running up and down my wife's body without any attempt to hide the filthy thoughts he was thinking. Zoe was talking to his buddies, who were smiling at her and making some kind of joke. Someone handed her a glass of champagne and then she sat down next to Max.

So I watched, as my wife tucked her hair behind her ear, and smiled her smile for Max while he played with her knee and drummed his fat fingertips in her inner thigh. They leaned closer and closer together, as she drank one, two, three flutes of champagne.

Then some kind of movement. They were all talking to each other. The strippers, Zoe, another girl who appeared to be there with one of the other guys, the guys. A flurry of activity, and then Max waved someone over from behind the bar. One of the security guys. The man listened to whatever Max was breathing into his ear and left.

Practically driven by my subconscious alone, I stood up and walked over to a table that was tucked away with a terrible view of the stage, but closer to the VIP "lounge." Close enough, I hoped, that I could hear what they were laughing about. Get a better view of my wife and her soon-to-be lover. Close enough that if I wanted to, I could stop her.

"This is not a very good move," the waitress said, appearing as if out of nowhere. She was smiling, but she had a look on her pixie face that she also meant some kind of business. "You wanna settle your tab with me?"

I was drunk. I was watching my wife snuggle up next to the ebony-skinned baseball player. I handed her my last \$100. "Keep them coming," I said.

I had always wanted to say that. But I barely heard myself. My eyes were on the stage so I didn't look like a wild man, staring at the group in the lounge. But all my attention was on the view next to the stage. My head started to hurt with the strain of watching peripherally, but I didn't care.

Front and center before my eyes, a blonde with enormous tits was floating around the pole. She had long legs and a very athletic build. She was a magnificent, ethereal creature wearing pink tassels on her tits that swung and glittered in the light.

To the right of this scene, though, was what I wanted to look at dead-on. My wife had risen at some point to look at something one of the

strippers was showing her. I heard the girl say, “here, here, I’ll show you,” and then my wife and she giggled with their heads together for a moment, Zoe was standing right in front of Max, and I saw the dark shadow of his arm lift, close in on Zoe, and slowly pull the hem of her skirt up, inch by inch.

He took the material of her skirt between his two fingers, and tugged gently on her skirt, until she stepped backwards, and then sank.

Plop. Right into his lap.

She wasn't facing me. I couldn't see what her expression was as she wriggled on Max Harris' lap. I wondered if his cock was hard – surely it was – and she was feeling out his size, imagining the shape of him as she wriggled over his thighs. Where was his cock? Under her leg? Against a thigh? Or pointed right between the crack of her ass? Could she feel it against her swollen clit, and that's why she was wriggling so much?

His dark hand was on her back, where the dress cut down low and revealed a good portion of her skin. He was stroking his fingers up and down the corridor of her spine. His hands mingled in her hair.

The music in the club changed abruptly, and the girl on the stage frowned and cast an ugly look toward what must have been the person in control of it. She kept dancing, though, unruffled. She approached the edge of the stage and crouched and squatted to get her tips, which seemed generous.

Then she gave a little spin and approached the VIP lounge.

I heard Zoe's laugh. I dared to look over at the group, directly, only for a second. I saw that the two strippers who had been lounging on the couches were getting up with two of the guys, and they were moving out of the lounge on the other side. Max was leaning in to Zoe, and I could see that he had his fingers on the front of her dress. He moved them up and down, and his lips were moving next to her ear. Zoe's body was rippling, as though she were trying to stretch. His hand kept her in place, and she turned ever-so-slightly. I could see her smile.

Max pulled on the front of her dress when she did this, and took a look inside the dress at her tits. After a good long look at my wife's creamy curves, and the little knobs of caramel in their center, he let go of the fabric. It snapped against her skin. He pressed his mouth together and sucked on his lower lip. A sign of approval. Max Harris had just cast a dirty look all over my wife's tits, and he liked what he saw.

Then she leaned down and whispered in his ear. Whatever she said made him chuckle, though I couldn't figure out precisely why.

And then she was gone. She stood up, exiting the way the other girls and Max's friends had gone.

I stared ahead, my eyes and my face burning with rage and confusion. What was she doing? Where was she going?

I played out all kinds of scenarios, and none of them were very much what I wanted at all. She had gone to the back rooms of this seedy little club, where there were surely places the girls had designated for doing more than just a little lap dance.

That was it, wasn't it?

The hulking mass of Max Harris began to rise in my peripheral vision. Up close to the man, I got a much better impression of his size. He was massive when all of his chiseled limbs were fully stretched out for him to stand.

It took all of my energy to keep my gaze on the stage, where two strippers were standing on the edge of it, and discussing something. I was grateful that I could at least try to look interested in them.

Was Max going to meet my wife somewhere? Back there? My stomach twisted.

I waited for him to leave and then I took out my phone.

But Zoe had already sent me a message.

[Zoe]: *In the bathroom. Plan has to change a little. M wants to have a private dance w buddies no way to get you in*

I stared at the phone. Private dance. I was pretty sure that meant you could take it all off.

I felt like I was getting ripped in half. My fingers hovered over the phone. This was too far, right? Not what I wanted.

[Zoe]: *M? You there? Do I do it or not?*

I typed furiously.

[Me]: *I have to think*

I waited.

My stomach felt like it was going to revolt. My waitress dropped off another drink. Even after all these drinks, I felt as sober as the day I was born. Probably because my heart was beating so fast I had burnt through them all.

The phone tittered in my hand.

[Zoe]: *I need an answer. But...if i don't go i think its prob all off*

I stared at my phone.

It was probably time to stop, I realized. I leafed through everything we had just done, to remind myself of that. The messages, the pictures, the fondling. Everything I had seen. Just to give myself a better idea of the fact that now *was the time to stop*. It had been thrilling. Time to go home and have hot sex.

It's prob all off...

The phone buzzed again.

[Zoe]: Chaz?

My head was reeling. I knew what the most prudent thing to do was. Hell. I always know what that is. Instead I typed:

[Me]: *OK*

OK.

What was that?

Later, I would wonder if I made her laugh. Such a stupid answer to the question. The thing was, I didn't really want to commit, one way or the other. OK. It seemed like maybe later I could say I meant something other than yes.

Because I did. I meant yes and no. Did I want my wife to go into some secret room with Max Harris and his buddies, to watch strippers in private?

Yes and no.

Did I want the whole thing to get called off because she didn't?

Yes and no.

I caught my own reflection in the mirror. I looked like a madman.

I raised my glass and gave myself a toast.

How much time went by?

It was about an hour, now that I've reconstructed the evening. One whole hour of me sitting by myself in a strip club, watching the stage from a distance and seeing nothing.

The girls kept getting better-looking as the night went by, and I doubt it was the booze because I never felt the least bit drunk. Slutty-looking redheads with tattoos and extraordinarily flexible legs did splits against the pole with nothing but a sequined triangle between our eyes and the answer to the question about the carpet. A sturdy girl who looked like she was from Sweden, with white-blond hair and ice-blue eyes, treated us to bad dancing that no one cared about because her ass and tits were so round and solid that we could ski on them. A raven-haired beauty with red lips pouted while she rubbed herself all over the pole like a cat.

I only vaguely saw any of this. The images I was cooking up in my own mind blinded me to what was happening in front of my face.

I imagined it would start a little tame. How would I know? My experience with private lap dances in strip clubs was limited to a couple of scenes from TV and movies. Maybe they were all gathered in a booth, guys and girls all snug together. My wife sandwiched between Max Harris and one of his buddies, their muscles against her skin, arousing with every movement. Maybe it was more of a sofa arrangement, and the girls were dancing on their laps, grinding them all to such an excited state that any moment they would burst apart in a wild orgy.

Whatever it was, it would only get more heated with every second.

I fantasized about getting up, jumping over the stage, and running to this room, wherever it was. Maybe I would get as far as the door, push it open, and see inside. I would get a glimpse of Max's dark legs and hands, contrasting with my wife's white body. Her torso would be rippling as she rode his big cock, and his fingers would slide down the sweat of her naked body and into the crack of her ass as she undulated faster and faster, tipped her head back, and moaned as she came.

I tried to lift the drink to my lips and I spilled it. I was really cracking up.

I kept checking my phone. As if there would be some little clue for me as to what she was doing.

But there was nothing.

Every minute wore away slowly and painfully. My fantasies got more spectacular with each one. Would she stop him if he tried to have sex with her back there? She wouldn't let more than one guy fuck her, would she?

I envisioned my wife between the hardened athletic bodies of Max and one of the men he had been sitting with. I pictured her moaning as she let them fill her up in every hole, their sweat soaking the back of her head and her face as they stretched her two holes and pumped her full of cum.

I looked at my phone again.

My fingers hovered over the keyboard to type a message.

What would I say?

Dear Zoe: Are you having a nice time?

My last message stared at me: *OK*.

OK, I had written. What the fuck had I done that for? Was anything OK?

Yes and no.

I started to type and then I stopped.

This was, after all, all about trust.

This was the game that Zoe was playing.

I felt a little better for a few minutes. I looked at the stripper, who was a plain-faced brunette with mousy hair but a killer – *killer* – body.

And then it all crashed down on me again.

After all, it had been different before. We had pretty much agreed we were going through with this. Everything was different now.

The pain seized me again, squeezing my heart. I went through all the same awful circles again, and came back to the same place: holding my phone, not knowing what to type.

“Fuck this,” I said, and I started to type:

Z-O-E- I- N-E-E

I mean, who knows where I was going with that. Who knows what I thought I was going to tell Zoe I needed? To talk some more? What?

Luckily I never had to finish the thought, because Zoe and Max Harris emerged at that moment from the back room.

Max Harris was *carrying* my wife. Like she weighed nothing. Her arms were thrown around his shoulders and she had her head tipped back and was laughing.

I scanned her appearance. Her ass hanging down between his arms, and her skirt hiked up so that at the right angle, anyone could see up it. I saw a flash of her underwear, so that was good. Good, in the sense that it was still on.

Right?

No actually, it meant nothing, I realized. My anger flared up around me, starting along my spine and wrapping hot fingers around my face. They could have done anything back there. Anything at all. I squinted, almost as if I believed that I could zoom in on Zoe's mouth like a telescope. And what would I look for if I did? Traces of cum on her lips, something that glistened and wasn't her own wet mouth? Just thinking about it sent my heart racing faster.

And so I sat there, and watched, as Max Harris carried my wife through a strip club, making her laugh all the way. They looked good together: Zoe with Max Harris was certainly a more sensible match than beautiful Zoe with plain Charles Grant. They were flashy, beautiful people.

Zoe's legs bounced playfully as Max headed with her toward the entrance.

And then she pulled herself close to him, like she was giving him an extra hug of some kind. The tenderness I mistook in it for a moment seared through me and was the most painful thing I had felt in a long time.

But then Zoe lifted her eyes, and they swept throughout the room quickly until they came to me. She lifted her chin, and rested it on his shoulder. She made a series of movements with her hands: I would straighten them out later. At the time they made no sense. I could only see Zoe's eyes, zooming in on mine, meeting me across the room.

The terrible, pained feeling washed away. Maybe I was a fool, but there was something in her gaze that let me know she was still with me. Even if Max Harris was carrying her around like a doll, and even if she was about to let him fuck her.

Max set Zoe down near the entrance. She adjusted her skirt, and they glided out of *The Corral*.

It was then that I made sense of Zoe's hand signals.

She would call me, she had said.

I sat for a moment. Now what the fuck did that mean? Was I supposed to wait here?

I tried to remember every detail of what she had done, every motion of her fingers.

“Oh fuck it,” I said.

Whether it was Zoe's plan or not, in a few moments I was out on the street.

They hadn't gotten very far. When I turned right, I saw Zoe almost immediately. Her lean figure in the white dress was eye-catching. She was leaning against the brick facade of the building next door, an ice-cream shop by day in the improbable downtown core of this city. She had one foot up against the wall, and the wind was picking up her hair. She laughed, and if she saw me she gave no indication of it at all as I walked toward them, my hands in my pockets. I had no idea what my plan was now. I had already started walking that way and I didn't want Harris to notice me. Or worse yet, confront me if he thought I was following them.

So I was going to keep walking. Then I supposed something would come to me. I was rather hoping it would work out like an espionage thriller and there would be some nice little entryway or alley to duck into so I could lean against the wall and make an “o” shape with my mouth while I listened in on them. Then they could walk right past me and never look back and I could keep following them. With a sinister look on my face.

As I passed them, I heard Zoe's sexiest laugh. She did it for me only when she had basically agreed to have sex. She had a bunch of different laughs, and each one said something different. Her, “I'm blowing you off for sex” laugh; her “you made a genuinely funny joke,” laugh; her “your joke is stupid and gross but I'm being polite” laugh. And then this one, a low throaty laugh that beckons.

More white-hot jealousy cut through me. I had always figured I would be the only person that laugh would be directed at. When I envisioned this fantasy, I had never even thought about the laugh. I had never imagined it anyplace in the events. Now it enraged me, though I knew I had no business being enraged.

“Oh yeah?” Max Harris was saying. His voice vibrated in the air like the idling motor of a sports car.

“It's true,” Zoe said, and her sexy laugh broke apart into a giggle.

Flirting. Senseless exchanges of words that no one was listening to, an elaborate dance before leaning in for the kiss, or more.

“Nuh-uh.” Max.

And silence. I was already past them, so I couldn't see them anymore. But the energy between them felt like it was actually disturbing the air. As though the image of them meeting together, of Max placing his finger on her lips, and then moving in to kiss *my wife* – it's as if it was actually disturbing the air and transmitting to me. I could feel it tingling on my back, screaming at me to turn and look back.

I kept my eyes on the sidewalk. In reality I only walked a few feet like that, but it felt like an eternity.

Then, slow motion:

Like a spy movie, a narrow passage next to the building on my right opened up. Just enough room for some garbage cans and a crazed husband. A cat jumped off the bin and I moved my body in a hard right toward the cans. I heard my foot grind on the sidewalk; some sand had been spilled there. Then I looked up and to the right.

The image was fleeting, because I walked right into that little alley as though I owned it. But it burned into my eye and I could see it perfectly as I squeezed past the garbage bins and looked out into the street. Max Harris had gone in. His hand was on Zoe's ass, and his fingers were pressing into her white dress, dipping into the plumpness of her ass. His mouth was on hers and she had melted into his kiss.

Another man was enjoying my wife's mouth right now. Feeling her huge breasts soft against his chest. And Zoe; surely she could feel his hard cock against her body now.

I waited, unable to strip the image from my mind. It lay over the actual sight of the street in front of me like a transparent overlay. My heart felt like it was being turned over and over in my chest, on a spit, burning and then cooling.

I heard them coming. Zoe's little footsteps and giggle. The crunch of the spilled sand under their feet. They were doing that thing, I could tell just by listening, where they walked a few feet and then they pawed at each other. We had been like that once. Excited. So turned on and anxious that we couldn't even make it to our destination without groping each other.

“Wait, wait, wait,” Zoe said. Her words struck me like a slap in the face. But then I realized she wasn't putting the brakes on anything. She was

laughing.

She was speaking in her “amplified voice.” She called it that because it's the one she had to use at work, or if she gave a seminar, or if she talked to anyone who wanted to hear her, because her voice was low and it disappeared into the background noise quite easily.

She was amplifying for me.

“I have to tell my husband something,” she said.

I was suddenly extremely cold with fear. She wasn't going...to call me, was she? I grabbed for my phone, praying it was on vibrate.

“What do I tell him?” Zoe said. Her voice was teasing. Sexual.

My stomach twisted as I grasped the game. She was pretending to tease Max Harris, letting him believe he was having some part in this cruel message to her husband. But in reality, it was a show for *me*.

Max Harris laughed. A dismissive laugh of a man who slept with other men's wives all the time. He was utterly unconcerned that she was married. It wasn't news, and I felt another flare-up of jealousy as I thought about where they might have shared this fact with each other. How. When. How much she had said to him about me, and if any of it was true.

“Tell him you're going out for ice cream,” Harris said, with a chuckle. “Chocolate.”

What a fucker.

There was a silence as Zoe did whatever she was doing, and I kept waiting. She was typing a long time, long enough that Max commented: “You writing War and Peace?” to which he got no replay. I imagined Zoe holding her finger up to him while she kept typing.

My phone buzzed in my hand. I was afraid to lift it and look at it, like maybe the glow of the screen would give me away. It burned against my palm, and it was all I could do not to lift it and read.

“What'd you say?” Max asked.

“Well...not ice cream,” Zoe said.

They walked past the alley at that moment. Zoe flicked her eyes in my direction, though she did it so smoothly I am not sure to this day if she meant to look at me or not. I thought I saw a little smile.

Their voices faded away.

I held up the phone.

[Zoe]: *Very sneaky. I'm going out for ice cream.
Chocolate (!) You have a key waiting at the
Sheraton Downtown.*

[Zoe]: *I love you.*

I stared at the messages.

My heart was going wild inside my chest. I wanted this exciting adventure, to be sure, but the feelings that were coming over me were almost too intense to handle.

I leaned my head out into the street.

They were gone. No Zoe, her long legs prancing in her white heels and white dress.

No Max, a foot above every other man on the street, arm linked with my wife.

A tide of panic came at me, like a tsunami. At my ankles and then over my head in an instant.

I turned in a circle, and then it was all true.

So I hailed a cab.

The cab driver turned out to be one of the most prudent and slow in the entire metro area. He plodded along behind the ceaselessly stopping traffic in the core, making no move to bypass a double-parked car until it was absolutely safe (ten minutes later), or to get around a vehicle turning left. He was patient, chatty, and I almost murdered him.

While he blathered on and on, and we sat behind the third left-turning vehicle in our way, I had plenty of time to think about Zoe. What was her plan? How did she intend to convince Max Harris to come to the room at the hotel? What if he didn't? Or what if it was her plan all along to send me there, make me wait and suffer all night, and then tell me she just didn't make it there the next morning?

I got my phone out twice to text her. Each time, I was unsure what I meant to text. Half of me wanted to demand that she just ditch him and meet me at the hotel. This was far enough, hot enough; we could live off it for a long time, couldn't we? The excitement of it up to this point? We didn't actually need to go all the way.

The other part of me is the part that won. The part of me that wanted to see just exactly where my wife would take this little game. The part of me that wanted to...well, win. Whatever that meant, exactly. So I took the phone out twice and put it away twice.

And then, when the longest cab ride in the history of my life finally ended, I walked, in a daze, to the front desk of the Sheraton. I waited with a crushing weight squeezing my chest, half-expecting there to be no key, or for some huge problem to occur. Instead, the receptionist smiled, asked for ID, handed me a room key, and told me to have a lovely night.

“You'll need the key in the elevator to access the upstairs floor,” she was saying, as I was already turning away. “Don't forget.”

I stared at the room “Number”

Dear Zoe. A Presidential Suite.

It didn't occur to me, though someone might find this laughable, that I might be arriving late to the party, until I had already pushed the door open. At that very moment, when the soft click rattled the door and it was too late to snatch the sound back from the air, it *did* occur to me.

What if I walked in on them? Right at the moment that Harris had placed the tip of his cock against my wife's dripping cunt?

I froze, cocking my head to listen for any noise at all. But the room was silent. I pushed on the door, which dragged on the ultra-plush carpet, and then I took a look around the Presidential Suite.

I had no desire to know what Zoe had dropped on this whole thing. The rooms of the suite were practically coated in money; expensive fabrics; a thick, expensive silence.

I put the expense out of my mind and tried to focus on the present.

Where to lie in wait for your wife, who may or may not be coming, any minute or a long time from now, into the extraordinarily-priced hotel room she had apparently rented for the evening with the intention of luring (though it wasn't taking much in that department) a famous athlete to. To have sex. While you watched.

There was really no place to hide, except behind a sofa placed to divide the bedroom and sitting room. And this would only work provided that the two of them didn't do anything except go straight to the bed. I crouched behind it, and it was horribly uncomfortable. I would have to lie

down if I really wanted any chance of not being seen. And Harris' height made all that much trickier. I felt certain he would see me if he looked in that direction.

I sat up.

I texted Zoe.

[Me]: *Nowhere to hide. You have a plan?*

I waited for what seemed like another eternity, the phone in my hand, my eyes darting compulsively around the room and then back at the screen. There was no response. Every second carved a slice of pain out of the inside of my chest.

I was practically sweating in despair and paranoia, and I was sure that even if I found a place to hide in this room, the smell of my jealous sweat would give me away. Or my breathing. And that was if Zoe was even coming.

But finally, just when I thought the pressure couldn't build any higher, my phone buzzed in my hand.

[Zoe]: *Were here. But were going to another room.*

My heart almost exploded. My vision went blurry, and for a second I thought I might stroke out, but the phone rumbled again against my palm.

[Zoe]: *It's all part t plan don't worry Ill snd u # just stay put*

All part of the plan?!! What fucking plan could Zoe possibly have in mind? They were here? *Here*, here?

I felt like a caged animal. I looked around the room, frantic.

They weren't coming here.

Why not?

I ran my fingers through my hair, trying to work my way through Zoe's plan. Zoe's plan. What the fuck could Zoe's plan be?

And why was Zoe so late? What had they been doing this whole time?

And then I started to get it. At least, it started to take shape in my mind, a little, this plan of Zoe's. Another room. They would go to another room because...well, never mind why. But she would tell me, right?

Don't worry. Trust me. It's a surprise.

Zoe's words, whether she had actually said them or not, bounced around in my mind.

"Okay," I said.

I went to the door, and I leaned my head against it.

The thing about doors on floors like this, or at least at this hotel, is they're not the shitty hotel doors the plebes get downstairs. This was a real wood door, and it was solid as a rock. Nothing.

My mind spun. How many rooms were there out there?

I pressed my eye practically through the peephole, until it gave me a headache. Nothing.

I opened the door to look out into the hallway. The door was swinging shut behind me when I realized I didn't have my room key. I stepped back in a panic, slammed my wrist into the door handle, and cursed.

At that precise moment, the elevator softly dinged.

I stepped back into the room and pushed the door slowly closed, holding it back so it didn't click.

My stomach dropped through the floor. I heard Zoe's voice. "Oooh, this is swan-ky," she said.

The low rumble of Harris' voice.

I was standing with my hand on the door handle. The position was suddenly awkward and hard to maintain. My door was open only a crack, but I didn't dare shut it. My heart was pounding. Which way would they go? Was there even another room in the direction of mine?

The shadows of their movements crossed in front of the peephole before I could think about it much more, and I froze. But they kept going, and I heard the smack of their lips against each other's as they passed. They weren't thinking about anything except themselves – or at least Harris wasn't thinking about anything but my wife's pussy and how he would get into it.

The crack was open just enough for me to see them, meshed together in a writhing mass of hands and skin. Harris was pushing Zoe backwards, and he was pressed up against her, clutching her body to his. Her feet were barely on the ground as they made their way toward their own room, and

his hand was between her legs. He had pushed her dress all the way up, and his dark fingers were rutting around between her legs.

Where, I realized with a shudder, she had no panties on.

I went cold again, right through my core. He pushed her into the door, fumbled with a key, and the door, with Zoe pushed against it, swung open.

It clattered into the room, a loud thud echoing into the hallway, and they slid into the room, without turning on the lights, joined at the lips. The last thing I saw was Harris' hand between her legs, moving up, taking her tight dress with it so her whole lower torso was exposed...and then the door swung shut behind them.

Click.

I stood there, dumbfounded.

What the fuck was I supposed to do now?

The door had slipped from my hand and closed. I never heard it or really noticed.

I don't know how long I stood there, staring at the peephole, rage building inside of me, with no outlet at all. I imagined throwing open the door, stomping over to their room, and pounding on the door with my fists. But where would that get me?

It was a while before I realized that something had vibrated at my feet. My eyes were stinging with tears of anger when I picked up the phone that had somehow dropped to the floor.

[Zoe]: *Call me*

I stared at the phone.

[Zoe]: *frstpart callme five mins*

What in the hell?

A sudden pain in my lungs told me I had stopped breathing. I sucked in a gulp of air and exhaled it. What was she saying? What was she doing?

Trust me.

It's a surprise.

I stared at the phone. Five minutes. Wait five minutes? Give her five minutes? Five fucking what minutes?

Wait. It could only mean wait.

Okay. This gave me something to do.

The minutes never changed on my phone though. No matter how long I stared at it. All I could see was Max Harris' hand, sliding along my wife's creamy skin, up, up, up to her tits – and what did that matter, if he'd already dipped his dark fingers into her pussy and gotten them slippery wet with her excitement?

Call her?

I made myself a drink (or rather, I took a whiskey bottle out of the nicely stocked liquor cabinet and drank it out of the bottle).

I wiped my mouth, because I had slammed the whiskey like a madman. I looked back at the phone. What would they be doing now?

If what they had been doing when they went into the room was any indication, Max Harris was inside my wife by now.

Call her.

And then I got it. Or, at least I thought I got it.

So I called.

And there it was. Zoe's plan. *First part. Five minutes. Call me.*

I held the phone to my ear.

Just as I suspected, the ringing disappeared. For a moment it just seemed as though there was silence on the other end. A muffled sound, a bit of rustling. Zoe's plan taking shape, my hopes rising up inside of me, my jealousy ignited as though she had thrown gasoline on it.

There was nothing to do but listen. Inside me, a voice was screaming that this couldn't be it, but it seemed like it was.

Listening.

The panting of two people who are mating. The sound was unmistakable. Whispers, fragments of sentences. "Get that off." "Turn around."

Max's voice, telling my wife what to do. More rustling.

And then Zoe moaning. It started low, but then it built up. Her voice sounded as though it were being squeezed from inside of her when she finally began to scream, "Oh fuck, just like that! Fuck, that's so hot, eat me out, make me come, make me come!"

Max Harris was eating my wife out.

And by the sound of it, unless Zoe was some tremendously talented actress, he was great at it.

Zoe's voice became strangled, she was reduced to panting just, "Oh fuck, oh fuck," and then she yelled. She yelled like I had never really heard her yell before. It was a sharp but long yell, and it wound down into practically a squeal. She was coming, hard, her clit under Max Harris' tongue. Her juices pouring into his mouth. Her pussy probably gushing all over the sheets.

Was she on her back, I wondered? Her legs spread open while he knelt on the edge of the bed and licked at her cunt? Or did he have her on her stomach, eating her out on all fours so he could immediately get to pounding into her from behind?

"That's it," Harris' voice rumbled.

Some more rustling.

Then I heard Zoe panting again. The panting was distinct. A little throaty moan squealed beneath it. The sound moved away and then close. She seemed to be tossing her head back and forth on the pillow.

"Oh fuck, I want your cock," my wife said.

"Yeah, you want it," I heard Harris rumble.

I squeezed my eyes closed. I don't know if I was trying to get the picture of them out of my head or imagine it with more detail.

"That's it. It's big, isn't it? Why don't you give it a little taste?"

I imagined Zoe smiling. And then I heard the terrible sound that I had known would come next. The sticky, wet sound of a cock in a woman's mouth. A pop, as she released it from her mouth. A gagged moan. More sticky sliding. Except this wasn't just any mouth. It was my wife's mouth, and the horror of what was actually happening kept hitting me over and over again, fresh every time:

My wife has a big black cock in her mouth.

My own cock was so hard by now that I had to get it out of my pants. I collapsed on the couch I had so foolishly believed I would be hiding behind. A desperation was building up inside of me: this was not enough. I wanted to be in the room with her, and here she was torturing me with the sound only. The sound of her sucking Harris' cock. But not the sight of it. I shuddered as I imagined it: Zoe's lips stretched wide around his veined slab of meat...

The sound suddenly changed, and Zoe was panting again. "Ohhhh," she moaned. "Please. Don't tease me any more. I just want you to fuck me."

And then a low, slow, agonizing moan. Her breathing stopped.

And then:

“It's so big. Oh fuck,”

Then just breathing. A squeal.

“We'll take this slow the first time,” Harris said.

I grabbed my own cock, and stroked it slowly at first, listening to the sound of Max Harris “taking it slow” this *first time* with my wife. I couldn't hear much except their panting. Then, beneath it, and even perhaps this was just my imagination, the sticky squelch of fucking. Fucking a woman who is gushing juices. A wet woman, whose excitement was sufficient to lubricate even the biggest cock.

The sound, of Max Harris stretching my wife's pussy and pounding it full of his first big load of cum.

Zoe started to scream again, and Harris encouraged her. “That's it. That's it baby, come for me again.”

And then I heard the thrusts of his huge cock in her drenched cunt, Zoe laughing a little, their skin slapping together, and then the groan of a big black man dumping his seed inside my wife.

The slap of an object on the floor, sliding against something.

Then silence.

I stared at the phone in my hand for what seemed like hours.

What could they be doing in there?

I paced from the couch to the door twenty or so times. Downed another whiskey.

My cock was still hard as a rock. I didn't want to jerk off, not if there was something more to this. Was she going to leave and come back here?

What I had just listened to had the confounding effect of being the hottest thing that had ever happened to me in my life, and the most disappointing, and the most awful, and maybe the best. I didn't know. I was losing my fucking mind. I kept picking up the phone and looking for a sign from Zoe. What to do next.

I wanted it to be over, and have her back in my arms.

I wanted it not to be over, and to imagine her spooned up against Harris right at that moment. I wanted her to feel his cock getting hard again against the small of her back, and I wanted them to fuck again. Maybe I wanted to listen again, maybe I wanted to just be left over here to wonder about it.

No. I wanted to see it.

Damn it.

I stared at the phone until it almost made no sense as an object.

Then it came to life.

[Zoe]: *When room service comes ill leave key
under door*

[Zoe]: *Then u get ur bday presentation*

“Presentation.” Spell check hilarity. It could make me smile even in this situation.

I looked up, out the window.

Trust me.

I felt suddenly bad for ever doubting her.

The key was under the door, sticking out just enough to be grabbed, just like Zoe had promised. I took it and started to insert it into the lock, when I realized I had no idea what I was doing. What was my plan? If this room was anything like my own, it would be a tricky thing to get in there.

I took the key and scurried back like a squirrel to my room.

A message was already waiting for me.

[Zoe]: *I'll keep him distracted. Go right to bathroom until*

I raised my eyebrows. Jesus. What would this guy do if I got caught? And what was the rest of this sentence? Until...he comes and murders you with a baseball bat?

But my wife was in there, right now. “Distracting” Max Harris from the door of his hotel room so I could sneak in and watch her. Watch her fuck him.

Fuck it.

I dropped the phone in my pocket, crossed the hallway, went up to the door, and filled with a sudden and amazing strength and clarity of mind, I slipped the key card in and -

It beeped red at me.

I took a deep breath and did it again, my cheeks burning. Red again.

Again.

The light flashed green at me. I stared at it so long I almost missed my chance to open the door.

I pushed. The click seemed louder than a shotgun.

I waited, my breath frozen in my chest. I was sweating; I could feel a single bead sliding down my temple. I was praying aimlessly to no particular god that no one had heard anything inside the door, that no one came out of their room outside the door. What would I do or say to explain why I was clutching a door handle, but not opening the door, while I dripped sweat onto the floor.

Jesus. What the fuck was I doing?

But the thing that was there, on the inside of the door, was too hypnotizing to turn down. And so I found myself pushing the door open.

Now I could hear them. I could hear Harris' low voice. He was sort of chuckling and murmuring. Seducing and amusing my wife all at the same time. He kept right on talking, even though the door was opening, so I went further.

I couldn't see them – only Harris' dark knee and Zoe's white flesh against it. It wasn't clear how they were sitting, or what they were looking at.

I took a deep breath. I could see the bathroom door.

I decided that the best thing would be to focus on getting into the bathroom, and not making the door click.

Now, of course, when I think about it, this was an incredibly bad idea. I was putting a fuck-ton of trust in my wife to keep Harris completely entertained, so that he didn't look up and see the white man creeping into his room with his eyes squeezed shut. Really. I could have gotten killed. Or at least beat up.

I did it anyway. After all, the whole thing was already so crazy. What was one more crazy thing?

I stepped inside and got the door handle behind me, still holding onto it. Having decided not to look into the room, I hear Zoe giggle and promptly changed my mind. My eyes snapped up to where the sound came from.

Zoe was on Harris' lap, naked. Well, mostly naked; she had apparently wrapped a sheet around herself to retrieve the room service order. The sheet was on Harris' knees now, and my wife's bare ass was in the palm of his

hand. He was just slipping a finger down the length of her crack, over her asshole, and into her pussy from behind.

The handle slipped from my sweaty palm, and the door, which was closed, made the faintest rattle as the handle flipped back up into position.

I moved with a catlike grace that surprised even me, into the bathroom. Quick, frantic glances around, in the semi-darkness, and I stepped into the already-opened shower (the door was glass, I realized as I stepped through it, and I felt doom falling down on me like a ton of bricks, or Max Harris' fist). But the shower was also large, and dipped into the wall, so there was plenty of room for me to press myself up against the marble and try to breathe.

In the meantime, Harris had said something, and I could hear Zoe walking around near the door.

Silence.

She gave a laugh. "Looks like a napkin fell out," she said.

I narrowed my eyes. Man, she was a good thinker on her feet.

Oddly, at that particular moment, Zoe's whole plan was visible to me. All the clever things she'd done, like getting a hotel room on this floor – of course, because there would be no way for me to get to the floor without a keycard. And Harris wasn't going to believe that she had already gotten a room for the night; he would have surely suspected *something*. Better to lure him here, which must have taken a bit of doing. And then to order room service, leave a key card for me... She was really *something*.

I could feel every pump of my heart slamming blood to my extremities. My hands and feet pulsed with every thud against my chest. The air was ringing. The cool tile of the bathroom did nothing to disturb the sweating heat that enveloped me.

Zoe had returned to Max, and whatever was doing had gotten him to forget the clicking door, and make him start growling instead.

I gave it a few minutes: long and torturous minutes, because now that I was so close and had risked so much to get to where I was, I was practically frothing at the mouth to see what seemed to be the main event of Zoe's grand scheme tonight. And standing there in the cold shower, my racing heart had gradually come under control, and my body was remembering the lust that had driven me here in the first place. My wife was about to fuck another man, and I would be able to see it for myself this time.

But I waited.

Finally, I stepped out of the shower stall and tip-toed to the door of the bathroom. I scanned my mind for a memory of the room's layout, but when I tried to think back to what I had seen, the only image I could conjure was of Zoe's pale ass, and the finger of black skin that was sliding between her two crests of flesh.

The sounds from the room had turned to moaning and smacking of lips. I lowered myself to the floor and peeked my head out.

The wall of the hallway ran on for a few feet, and then the room opened up, like mine, to a sitting room with a sofa, and to the right the bedroom area, where Zoe and Harris were entwined on a large chair. Harris was seated, and he wasn't facing the door or the hallway where I was, but was turned slightly toward the bed. Still, he could easily see me if I went any further. Or if he caught something in the corner of his eye.

For now, though, there was very little chance of that happening, because my wife was seated on his lap, her knees folded up beneath her. She was stretching up toward the ceiling, sort of rising on her knees. Harris was circling one of her nipples with his tongue, and I had peeked my head out just in time to see him make a few swirls, and then suck Zoe's caramel nipple in between his fat dark lips. His hands were cupping each of her buttocks, and so he looked like he was just devouring my wife, unreservedly.

He moved his head to her other nipple, and Zoe continued her feline stretch, holding her mass of hair up with her hands so that it fell in tangled locks as she moved her hands with abandon. She moaned with such a porno-grade stickiness to it that my cock throbbed painfully in my pants.

Harris' left hand went around her body and dove between her legs, while he held her firm with his right. Whatever he did with the left hand, it made Zoe gasp and tip forward, losing her composure for a moment. She fell toward the back of the chair, and Harris released her nipple to focus on what he was doing with his fingers. I could see that they were working inside of her, fanned out so that two of them plunged into her wet cunt, and his thumb rubbed against her clit.

With his right hand, he drew some of her abundant juices up the length of her asscrack. A shudder went through me as he drew her moisture up and over her ass. Once, twice, each time lingering a little longer on her puckered hole. He pulled with his other fingers on the flesh of her ass, to

give his pointer and middle finger better access to lubricate her asshole. So I had an excellent view of the pink eyelet, the glistening juices he was drawing to it, and the play of his fingers around the small hole.

Zoe's body rippled each time he dragged his finger around her ass. He was still moving his fingers inside of her cunt; the powerful muscles of his forearm were flexing and relaxing in rhythmic pulses.

Zoe gave another deeply sexual, dirty moan. The muscles of her legs were flexing, and she was close to coming. Harris swept the tip of his pointer finger around her ass.

Then, as Zoe began to gyrate with her rising arousal, nearing climax, Harris just slipped his pointer finger right in. It slipped straight into her ass as though it were nothing, and he kept on plunging until he reached the palm of his hand. The rest of his huge, veined hand was splayed across her asscheek.

Zoe's reaction? She just leaned her head back and moaned: "Oh god." She sounded surprised, but she didn't try to get away. She leaned forward again, and Max Harris began to finger-fuck my wife in her ass, using the brace of his big hand against her butt cheek to draw his finger in and out of her tight hole.

"Oh fuck," I heard Zoe say.

He was also still stroking her with his other hand, rubbing her clit and sliding his two fingers in and out of her pussy.

"Oh god," Zoe said again. She began to squeal.

"You like that, don't you?" Harris said.

As Zoe began to rise up and down on his lap, I got my first glimpse of his cock. I could see it, but only in brief flashes, between my wife's legs and his hand. It was dark, and there was no mistaking what it was – veins climbed over it like vines, and while I couldn't see the full thing, the girth of it was evident in these small peeks.

Zoe threw her head back again, and the sounds of Harris' fingers became sloshier and stickier. Finally, Zoe screamed. It began as a low, guttural moan, crescendoed to a shriek, and then, as Harris continued to slam all of his fingers inside of her, it wound down to an animal growl.

She sat down on his lap.

He pulled his fingers from her pussy, and brought them to her lips. Zoe didn't hesitate to make a show of licking each of his fingers from the base to the tip, and then suck the ends of them like the crown of a cock.

His other finger was still in her ass.

I stared at the scene, and I pushed myself backward into the bathroom, looking down at the floor, for a moment. The feelings that gripped me were making me sick.

When I peeked my head back out, still keeping low to the floor so that Harris wouldn't notice me, he was looking into Zoe's eyes, reading her expression. And he was adding a second finger to the first, slowly entering her ass.

The look of smug pleasure that came over his face as he watched my wife's expression seared through me. Zoe's mouth was open, but beyond that I couldn't see much more. He was working his fingers up into her asshole more rapidly now, kneading her insides and making her rise and fall like a puppet with the mere motion of his fingers. They were deep inside of her now, and the tendons on his hands moved as he wiggled his fingers back and forth.

I heard Zoe gasp, and then she began to rise up and away from his probing hand. He placed a hand on her shoulder and pushed her back down. Gently. "You can do it," he said.

Zoe made another porn-star sound and moaned: "I've never done this before."

But the sound of her voice was not a protest. It was an invitation.

It also wasn't entirely true, but I could vouch for the fact that she had never "done this" after trying it one time and not even finishing it. I stared at my wife, flopping whoreishly on another man's lap, letting him thrust his fingers deep inside her ass. *Was this really her?*

"Let Max take care of it," Max grinned, that same assured, smug grin. He bit down on her nipple again, pulling her tit toward him with his teeth for a moment. He let it go, and her breasts bobbed against her chest.

Suddenly, and too quickly for me to react, Max stood up. He used one hand to hold Zoe to him, keeping his fingers embedded in her ass. She was pressed to his lower abdomen, and she wrapped her legs around him.

This gave me an even better view of her ass and the fingers that were spreading it open.

But it also gave a better view, a complete view, of Harris' enormous cock.

It was pointed straight in front of him. The thickness was maybe twice that of an average guy. Like, say, me. It almost looked unreal. The

flesh was dark, darker than his skin, and so the veins that criss-crossed the surface of it appeared purple. He was rock-solid, and the whole thing looked like it might split open with the strain of his erection. It was long, probably a real ten inches, and yet it was so hard it barely bobbed when he rose.

He slipped his fingers from inside my wife and then he tossed her on the bed. She disappeared from view, and he also did, shortly thereafter.

Now, I would have to move. I supposed there was nothing to do but crawl along until I could see the bed.

I peeked around the corner, but I was unsatisfied with the view. Harris was now facing away from me, so I slowly rose until I was standing. There I could see the bed and Harris very clearly – and the writhing form of my wife. And her smile, directed at Harris, as he began to use her body.

Harris was kneeling on the bed. He pulled my wife toward him by the ankles. He pushed her legs open and then grasped her thighs to pull her toward him. He placed his hand on his own cock, and rubbed the tip of it up and down the length of her pussy. When he pressed into her clit she gasped.

He teased her like this until she was worked up again.

Then, I stared in horror as he pointed the tip of his cock against her cunt.

Sure, I knew this had really happened already. But now, seeing her pussy dripping with so much excitement and cum that her whole center was soaked and shiny, and seeing the size of the head of Harris' member, I went cold again.

And then hot. Hot as she squirmed beneath him, and raised her chest and moved her head around.

He slid his cock in slowly, and her pussy unfolded for him until was stretched to a thin line of red around his meat.

Harris fucked her slowly, even though she was so worked up that she twisted around beneath him and begged him with her eyes to bring her to orgasm faster. Methodically, he brought out her climax by slowly fucking her, letting her enjoy every inch of his cock. He went all the way in, all the way to the base, pressing his balls up against her, squeezing himself in a few inches deeper. He let her squirm there, filled up by all of his thick dick, and then he slowly teased his way out, and let her writhe on the sheets, with the tip of his cock just kissing her stretched entrance.

I could see her getting more and more desperate to come, but Harris just coaxed her calmly. "That's it. Get my cock nice and wet."

Finally, she came, and she screamed when she did.

But Harris simply let her rock out her orgasm, which she did for several minutes, without fucking her any more.

And then, when she was done, and panting against the sheets, her face wild and glowing, he slowly pulled out of her.

Then he flipped her over on her stomach, and, moving her like a doll, he walked her knees forward so that her ass was in the air for him.

Her pussy was so wet it was dripping down her thighs. It looked like a burst flower, a little ragged and swollen and red. Cum had dripped down to her ass, so her crack and even her buttocks shone for a moment with her wet excitement, just before it dried against her hot skin.

Harris drew gobs of her juices and cum up to her asshole, and then he began to make a little swirl around it. He took her by the cheeks and pulled her ass open.

I watched as he dipped one thumb into her, and then, before she could even finish the gasp that it inspired, he dipped another. His two thumbs plunged inside of her ass, and she let out a pained moan and turned her face into the pillow.

Then he pulled her ass open, and she lifted her head. "I don't know," she said. "I've never...I've never..."

Harris was leaning over her, and he let a big droplet of spit fall right into the center of her ass. Then another.

He slid his fingers out from inside of her.

"You can do it, baby."

Zoe turned her head, and looked toward me. She raised her eyebrows.

I stared. I could really get no other expression to cross my face.

Then Zoe smiled. Her mysterious little smile. She did it briefly, and she did it while looking at me.

Then she began to moan. She rose up on her hands and knees and tossed her hair as she looked back at Max.

"Oh," she moaned, and I could hear the drama in her voice – it was almost so exaggerated it was silly – and I wondered if Max could, too. "I don't know. You're too big, I've never..."

But Max was already pressing the crown of his fat cock against her hole. She was a little stretched by his fingers, and so the rim of her ass sort

of kissed the very tip of him. He dipped his fingers into her pussy one more time, and rubbed her juices around his cock.

“Oh!” Zoe shrieked, as he pushed forward an inch. The big tip of his cock moved slightly, but the whole thing folded a little: he was meeting some resistance stretching my wife's ass open.

“It's too big,” Zoe panted. “I can't...”

But Max slid a little bit more in, and Zoe's ass spread open.

And then, just like that, the tension seemed to be gone, and the whole length of Max Harris' cock went sliding easily into my wife's ass.

I watched inch after inch of his black dick slip in, my mouth open, until he was all the way to the base of cock and his balls slapped lightly against her pussy.

Zoe had turned to face forward, and her mouth was open. But she was taking it with incredible ease, which made something twist inside of me.

Harris began to piston in and out of Zoe's ass. Each thrust made a quiet sticky sound, now that his meat was so tightly sheathed by her flesh. He stared down at her as he began to pump harder and more rapidly.

My wife tossed her hair again, and turned toward me. She appeared to be looking back at Max, but she let her eyes drift over to where I was watching. Her mouth was open, and she moaned that same, squeaky and throaty moan for Harris. When her eyes met mine, however, she closed her mouth and gave me her smile.

Harris was groaning as his own orgasm began to creep up on him. “Fuck, baby, that's so hot, your ass is so hot,” he said. He placed a big hand on her lower back and began to push her back and forth on his cock.

But my wife had other plans. She herself began to ride his cock, and she pushed him gently backward with her ass until he was sitting on his knees. His huge muscular legs were folded into a v-shape and my wife rose up to seat herself on his cock and ride up and down the length of it. “Oh Jesus. You dirty little slut,” Harris said. “You like that cock in your ass, huh?”

I watched as Zoe undulated and bounced on Harris' cock. The view she was giving me now was extraordinary. She kept up the rhythm that Harris had started, and he leaned on one hand, reaching for her left breast with the other.

When he could take it no more, he grabbed her swinging hair, and wrapped it around his hand. Then he pulled her down, down, down onto his

cock, each thrust resonating with a hard slap. I heard him groan, and he pushed her forward onto her knees suddenly. She fell to her chest and he pummeled his cum into her, yelling as he did so. He gave a final, deep thrust, and Zoe opened her eyes and bit the tip of her thumb, looking at me as he did.

I knew I needed to get out of there, but something inside of me made it hard to turn around.

I waited. Zoe squinted her eyes, and I could see she urgently wanted me to leave.

But I wanted something. The whole vision just wasn't complete.

Zoe waved at me as Max Harris continued to fuck her lightly, squeezing out the last drops of his come. "Fuck," he said. "Fuck, that was fucking hot."

Then he stopped, his big cock still sunken into my wife's ass, and looked up at the ceiling. He was panting. But he didn't do what I realized I wanted him to do, desperately: he didn't slide his big dick out her ass so I could see her gaping hole, and watch his white cum well up from deep inside of her and dribble out of her ass.

Just thinking about it made my dick so hard the pain of it almost doubled me over.

Zoe squinted at me again.

I forced myself to step backward.

I listened, but Harris showed no sign of pulling his cock out of her.

Backward. This was my chance to get out without getting caught, I knew.

My hand was on the door. I was turning it.

"Mmmm," Harris was exclaiming. "You sure you never done that before?"

Zoe's laugh.

The scrape of the door over the carpet.

A pleased murmur coming from Max's throat. Surely something that Zoe was doing to distract him.

I needed to go. *Go*.

My eyes went to the bathroom. Had there been anywhere, anywhere at all to hide in there?

Couldn't I make a run for the sofa, and pray no one went back there?

But no. I stepped into the hall, switching my grip on the door and slowly pulling it closed behind me.

I closed the door, squeezing my eyes shut again, like I would bring about silence if only I couldn't see.

I almost fell over the room service cart.

Then I practically ran to my room, and shut the door, then stood there, panting.

How much time went by, as I just stood there, sweating and panting and replaying everything I had just seen? The adrenaline of escaping began to wear off. I started to feel very pleased with myself for pulling it off.

Then there was Zoe. The thought of all the filthy things my wife was doing pressed inside of me, made me insane with jealousy and aroused with the most white-hot lust I had ever felt. Every part of me was plummeting or floating on clouds.

My phone buzzed in my pants pocket.

Fuck. Had I really been such an idiot to take it with me? If anyone had texted me while I was lying on the marble floor I would have been doomed by the clatter of the phone.

I fished it out.

[Zoe]: *Did you like it*

A sharp pleasurable pain sliced through me.

I typed. I was grateful for typing, because if I had been forced to speak I would have just blubbered away like a moron.

[Me]: *Yes.*

She wasted no time in responding.

[Zoe]: *Just yes? Not v enthusiastic*

I rushed to clarify.

[Me]: *I fucking loved it*

I waited.

Zoe delivered me a smiley face.

Then:

[Zoe]: *Wait for me. Im coming over in a bit*

I stared at the text.

[Zoe]: *WAIT for me. You know what I mean...*

I looked past the phone to my cock.

[Me]: *How long?*

[Zoe]: *Hes in the shower right now. Maybe 1 hour*

[Me]: *Not sure i can wait that long zoo*

Damn, autocorrect.

I could see Zoe laughing. She sometimes called herself “Zoo” because she found it so amusing.

But her response was only this:

[Zoe]: *but be ready to go see you xoxoxo*

One hour.

I sat down on the bed, kicked off my clothes, and jerked off in almost no time at all to the image, extraordinarily, of my wife lying on her stomach, typing her messages to me while answering some question from her big black lover.

I say extraordinarily, because after everything I had just seen – his fingers in her ass, his big cock in her pussy, her moaning and screaming and riding his cock – it was the most unusual of choices.

After I came, I was back to hard again in no time.

I took a shower, trying to get my mind off Zoe and what she was doing now, and how long it would take her to get here.

What was she waiting for, anyway?

They still had their room service, I realized. What were they eating? Was he feeding her chocolate-dipped strawberries and champagne, watching her nibble on the fruit until her mouth was stained red and his cock was hard again? Would he fuck her again before she said she had to go home?

And then my phone rang.

I looked at the screen in disbelief.

Zoe.

I answered.

"Zoe?" I said. My voice, I realized, was slightly panicked. And then I realized that maybe I shouldn't have said anything at all. Maybe she was just calling me to let me in on another audio-sex session.

"Honey?" she said. "Oh, I wasn't expecting you to answer."

I heard, very definitively, the sucking sound of a kiss on Zoe's skin. Her voice became distracted, and she paused a little too long.

Even though it was pure theater, it was hot as fuck. I could feel as though she were calling me, some lover moving his lips all over her body, while she made an excuse for not being home.

"I thought...I would leave a message...I'm a little...caught up at work, a whole carload of people, and I'm just...going to stay with...Maxine."

There was a little edge of a giggle in her voice as she said "Maxine." Even though I was in on the joke, I felt a profound jealousy, tinged with worry, building up inside. I could think of nothing to say.

But Zoe was already talking as though I had responded. "No, you've met her, I'm sure of it. She was at a cookout?"

"Yeah. I have to be in for an early shift tomorrow, yeah. I switched with someone."

I breathed into the phone.

"I love you too, honey," Zoe said blithely.

And then, just before silence, a little giggle. For someone else.

So I sat there, unsure about what the purpose of the call was. Was she calling me to tell me she *wouldn't* be over? Or what?

I wrote a text:

[Me]: *I don't get it*

And then I decided that it would make me look like an idiot if there was something terrible lurking in Zoe's plans.

So I waited.

I drifted off to sleep, my head filled with images of Zoe and Max Harris, and it was one of those sleeps where you believe you are still awake. In the dream I had, I slid off the bed and crept back into the room to watch Zoe and Max again, but when I opened the door Max was standing in front of me.

I started awake, and then lay staring at the ceiling. The last time I had looked at the clock it was 1:30am. A full hour after Zoe had called, and time had just kept on ticking away.

I started to drift off again, and then I heard it.

A soft click.

The door. Open.

Closed.

Another soft click.

I raised myself up on my elbows.

And there she was.

I blinked.

She giggled, and slipped off the short hotel bathrobe she had put on.

I blinked again.

"He's sleeping," she said, in explanation. "So I'd like to make this pretty quick."

My jaw dropped open.

"Well," she said. She was grinning mischievously. "Aren't you going to say anything?"

She tossed herself onto the bed and stretched out her long body. She placed her arms up on the pillows and looked at my face. She blinked with a faux innocence. "I'm all yours, at least for another half hour or so."

If my mind was moving slowly, my hands and my body had the good sense to react. I moved my hand to her knee, placing my palm on her kneecap and stroking the underside with my fingertips. Then I slowly moved up her thigh, and she trembled underneath me. "You're not too tired?" I said. My fingers went to her pussy. She was so wet and dripping with cum that my fingers felt like they were sinking into a warm melon that

had just been cut open. At the height of summer, filled with sticky, sweet juice.

And another man's cum. I rubbed my fingers together and felt the mixture, silky and slimy.

“Or too sore?” I added.

Zoe bit her lip. “I *am* a little bit sore,” she said. “But I suppose I can make an exception.”

She reached down for my cock, and smiled when she felt it. She closed her fingers around me and guided my cock to her drenched opening.

I moved on top and slipped into her. It was like sinking into butter. There was almost no friction as my cock sank into her stretched and used pussy. My cock pulsed when I thought about how I was dipping into my wife, filled by another man. That I was going to add my own cum to her used cunt, and then, it seemed, she would go back to him for some more.

I breathed out, and a shudder went through me.

She raised her hands back up and over her head.

“Zoe,” I said. “I’m going to...I can’t last very long...”

She smiled her little smile. She shrugged. Then she wrapped her legs around me, and a gush of the juices inside of her spilled over my balls. “I didn’t let myself come the last time Max fucked me,” she whispered. “So neither can I.”

My whole body went stiff as I contemplated what she had just said, and tried to fight off the climax that was rushing at me.

We ground against each other, not for very long, but intensely, until at the same time we both went rigid with our orgasms. I opened my mouth and grunted, and Zoe just shuddered to her climax without making any real sound.

She was silent for a while, and I lay on top of her, reluctant to slide out from inside of her. Finally, I pulled her with me as I rolled onto my side. My cock slipped out slowly. I was still pretty hard, and the tip of me stayed inside her as we cuddled.

“Did you like your surprise?” she said finally, with a grin.

I felt my cock pulse against the top of her cunt, and her eyes twinkled. There was her answer.

“How long did you plan this?” I said, my head still spinning with all the details.

Zoe kissed me. “It’s all on the fly,” she said. “I’m *that* good.”

Then her face revealed the first and slightest trace of worry. “Just..”
“What?” I said.

“I don't know...you're sure you're okay with all of this?”

I smiled a little. It was too late now, wasn't it? I pulled her leg up and over my hip. “Are you kidding me?” I whispered. “It's fucking incredible.”

She smiled, and chewed a little on the end of her thumb.

I was getting hard again, and ready for more of Zoe, but she slipped away from me with a smile.

“I have to go,” she whispered, rising up to her knees after trailing kisses down my chest. “I'm supposed to be swimming.”

She pulled the skimpy robe around her body and tied it. I sat up on my elbows again. She looked spectacular in that robe. Zoe had always been spectacular, but now, with her mussed hair and her secretive grin, and the hotel bathrobe parted to reveal more than just a glimpse of her full breasts, she looked like she could be in the pages of Playboy.

“In what?” I said, referring to her swim.

She shrugged. “No one will be there,” she said.

“I could go,” I offered.

She shook her head and scrunched up her nose. “It's a cover for Max,” she said.

I think it was the first time she said his name. A spark of jealousy flared inside of me. Funny, that a thing like that could make me twist with almost as much jealous rage as watching her fuck him.

She smiled, and trotted away, out the door. She closed it quietly as a mouse.

HOME

I sat there for about five minutes. Maybe just two.

Then I got out of bed.

I'm not really sure what my plan was. Just that I was going to the pool. Did I intend to swim naked? Just watch my wife do it? Confront Max Harris? Fuck my wife in the pool? I had no idea.

The pool was two floors down. I wandered around the halls, trying to be quiet – it was about 3am now – for a long time before I had the presence of mind to read the signs directing me there.

The door was clearly marked with advisories that it was open 4am-12pm, but evidently not locked. The clear, blue water of the pool was still lit up, though the rest of the area was dark, and the liquid reflections of light and movement glimmered all over the walls: Zoe was in the pool.

I entered and stood at the edge of the pool. She was swimming breast stroke. Totally naked. The water distorted her perfect figure, but only just a little. Her hair was wet; she probably dove in.

When she turned around and saw me, she did not seem surprised. She just smiled her little smile, and swam back in my direction. The same little smile on her face the whole way.

She glided up to the edge of the pool, and placed her hands on the tiled border. Her breasts, from this angle – watery and glimmering, a little buoyant in the water - were spectacular. Her mouth turned up and she kicked her feet under her and swam backwards, her whole body visible. Her trimmed snatch and her breasts skirted along above the water. “Fancy seeing you here,” she said. “Pool's closed, you know.”

Then she turned on her stomach, and glided to the other end of the pool on a single kick.

At that moment, I saw movement out of the corner of my eye. My heart plummeted as I turned and saw the dark, hulking mass of Max Harris filling the doorway.

Moving.

Coming into the pool area.

He gave me nothing more than a quick glance, and some instinct inside of me decided to turn as though I were just walking past the pool all

along. Blessedly, I saw the doors to the shower area ahead of me. I was in a robe, but I had my boxers and sandals on. Some mixture of humiliation and anger burned through me as I walked toward them, unsure of what my plan might even be.

I heard Max's voice behind me.

“So you actually went swimming, huh? I wondered what you'd do without a suit.”

Nothing from Zoe. Probably, I thought, as I paused just inside the first turn of the shower room walls, she was just giving him her little smile. Swimming around naked and enticing.

“There room in there for one more?” I heard him say.

What the fuck? Were these two actually going to get into the pool naked together? The audacity, first of all. And what was I supposed to do? Peek out the shower? Stay in there?

I heard Zoe's light laugh. Whatever it was I was supposed to do, she seemed to be leaving it up to me.

I stood there for a while, my cock getting harder and my mind whirling, wondering what it was that I should do. Wanting to watch, wanting to escape. *Not* wanting to be there after it was all over, walking out of the pool area with my robe balled up in front of me to cover my erection from having just sneakily watched my wife have sex with another man.

I heard their voices, low and secretive now. Zoe said something, and someone got out of the water. Then another body out of the water.

Thank god, I thought. She was luring them back to his room. My stomach twisted. I was already plotting a way to get back in there, risking everything, to see them together again.

But shadows moved on the walls and voices drew closer, and I had the horrible realization that they were coming toward the locker room.

Laughing.

Stopping every now and then to smack their lips together. Grope each other.

“What about that guy?”

Zoe's voice. *That guy*. Just like her use of Max's first name had sliced through me, the pain of her talking about *me* like that – no matter how much of an act it was - was almost intolerable.

“I'm sure he'll get the hint.” Max.

And just like that, there they were. Zoe had her arms around his shoulders and they were locked in a passionate kiss. I was standing there, just around the first bend, and I must have looked like an idiot. I was blocking their way. They were inches from me. Max looming larger than ever – the guy was really ripped – and Zoe, naked and wet from head to toe, dripping and glistening on every square inch of her body. She smiled, but it was a smile of no recognition.

“Uh..” I said.

Max laughed, and he shared a look with me. The guys' look. The, “you-know-how-it-is-when-you-have-a-hot-naked-woman” look.

And for a moment, I was already walking away. Leaving my wife there in the arms of Max Harris. Sitting in my hotel room waiting for her to come back and give me the details.

I could actually feel my balls being squeezed as I, Charles Grant, instead of doing that, held up my robe, which was balled in my hand, and pointed it at Max Harris.

“Hey. You're Max Harris, aren't you?”

And then, I looked from him, to Zoe, to him again. A smile started to creep across my face.

I had no idea where this was coming from, but my mouth was a little ahead of my brain.

Zoe looked incredibly amused. In fact, the fact that I had surprised her, and the way it was spreading out across her face, was worth whatever beat-down I was flirting with getting.

“Aren't you...married, man?” I said.

Zoe let her head fall back and made a throaty, laughing sound. She was smiling. This was the sort of twist that amused her.

Harris' face had gone stone-cold sober, though. I could tell he was weighing everything now. What kind of man I was, what it was I was saying by saying that. Would I be the go-to-the-press type? The blackmailing type? Or was I just making a statement of fact?

“Look man,” he said, and I was surprised that he actually seemed a little bit sheepish. “You know how it is.”

I blinked at him, as if I didn't understand.

Zoe leaned in to Max's ear, and she whispered, but loud enough to hear, and all the while looking at me: “Let me take care of this.”

And then my wife moved toward me, and put her arms on my shoulders. I stared at her, and I was pretty sure that it was a convincing act for Max Harris, because she was taking me just as much the fuck by surprise as if the whole thing were really happening the way *he* believed it was.

“Now, sir...I'm wondering if maybe there's something I can do to convince you to act like you never saw us here..” Her hand went down to my cock, which she felt through my boxers. I dropped my robe.

Max Harris might as well have never existed for a few moments, as Zoe slid down the front of my body, looking right into my eyes the entire time, her amused little smile on full-throttle. She got on her knees, and wrapped her hand around my cock to guide it to her mouth.

It was then that I realized Max Harris was still in the room, because he let out an impressed chuckle at the same time that he dropped the white towel he had wrapped around his waist to the floor. He put his hand on his cock, which was very nearly grazing it against Zoe's hair, just behind her.

Zoe took me into her mouth. For a moment she teased me, sucking on the crown and moving her tongue in circles around the ridge of the glans. Then she went all the way to the base of my cock, and I felt the crown slide over the softness of her back palate, into her throat. She kept her eyes on mine, and somehow, her face was still smiling. She bobbed up and down on my shaft, slurping and sucking hard.

Then she released me, gave me another grin, and very slowly turned to Max Harris' fat cock. She had lifted her hand and wrapped it around his member while she was sucking on me, and so she did nothing more than guide him to her mouth.

And there she was. My wife. Just inches from me, her lips spreading around the fat black column of Max Harris' cock.

She struggled to get all of him inside of her. His cock was so thick her jaw seemed on the verge of breaking as she took him all the way to the base. I saw a ripple in her stomach as she gagged a little. But she kept right on going.

She sucked him a few times, up and down the length of his shaft.

Then she turned back to me.

She kept at this for some time. Going back and forth between Max and me, taking each of us all the way to the base of our cocks. I held on as long as I could, just to get a good look at it, and watch as much as I could.

But I sucked in my breath at last, to let her know I was coming, and she smiled and massaged me inside her mouth until I burst in her throat.

She didn't pull back, she just lifted her eyes and met mine as my cum filled the back of her mouth and dribbled into her throat.

She let me go with a pop, and licked her lips.

Then I felt her hand on my hand, and she took my left index finger inside her mouth. I looked at her strangely, and then she smirked at me. She reached up another hand, and played with the ring on my finger as she nibbled on the end of it. "Looks like Max isn't the only one who's married," she said.

And smiled.

Max let out a laugh, and I made a noise like someone had punched me in the stomach. She handed me my towel, and turned back toward Max's cock.

I left quickly. I cast a sidelong glance at the scene I was leaving behind, of Max smiling down at my wife, his hand on the back of her head, pushing her deep onto his thick cock.

Thinking he'd really gotten away with something.

I smiled as I opened the door.

Charles Grant wins this round.

EPILOGUE

“It's another one,” I said to Zoe, lifting her phone to look at a message from “MH,” whose phone number had since changed several times, but who never forgot to give my wife his new number.

Zoe rolled her eyes. “He's persistent.”

“You must have left an impression.”

We were out for dinner, months later, just Zoe and I. I say, “just Zoe and I,” because this was an evening we had decided to dedicate just to ourselves. No...extra activities.

I was still holding the phone. “He's only here for one night,” I said. Harris had been traded to the Dodgers, so Zoe only saw him on away games here.

But still, he always seemed to try for a little action. Even living in LA, where I'm sure beautiful women abounded, he liked to have his little fix of Zoe when he came back.

“So if you want to...” I suggested.

Zoe smiled at me again. Her secretive smile. There was a long, teasing pause.

“Nah,” she said finally, reaching for her wine.

I set the phone down.

I took my own wine glass in hand. “You ever going to tell me what happened after I left the locker room?” I tried. I had been dying to get this information from her since that wild evening.

I never got anything more than her secretive smile.

Which she gave me now.

But then, just when I was thinking that was all, she stopped with her wine glass mere millimeters from her lips. “We *do* have an anniversary coming up, after all.”

I stared at her.

She shrugged and smiled.

“I never know what to get you.”

And the grin.

END

MORE FROM ARNICA BUTLER

*If you enjoyed Grand Slam,
give my other novels a try!*

See [My Author Page](#) for a complete list of books, or...

[A Well-Laid Trap \(2-Part Series\)](#)

It all begins when Patrick is convinced he saw his wife with another man at a downtown bar.

He begins to investigate. But the more Patrick uncovers about Jordan's activities, the less he understands.

The biggest problem is, Patrick can't decide how he really feels. On the one hand, his wife seems to be betraying him, and on the other, his sex life has reached a scorching pinnacle he never thought possible.

But he had better hold on to his hat, because when he finds out the truth, things will get much, much hotter than he might have ever imagined...

[Ela's Performance](#)

Peter's sweet-faced and fiery wife is headed back to school for a degree in violin performance. Unexpectedly, Peter finds himself becoming very paranoid about who Ela is spending so much time with, and what she is doing at school so very late. It isn't as if he doesn't have his reasons for suspicion. There's the way his own relationship with Ela started, and their own past experiment with an open relationship before they were married. A few other strange things to fuel his jealous fantasies...

And when he discovers someone from Ela's past has resurfaced, he'll take a chance and confront his own desires and obsessions...but will he get what he really wants?

The Hobby Job

Former career professional Laura is going crazy living her stay-at-home-mom life in a small country town. Her husband Conrad has the perfect solution: get a “hobby job.” Laura gets turned on to the idea, and to Conrad's surprise, chooses to wait tables at a run-down restaurant down the street. But she gets a lot more than a hobby job when she meets Nate, a young, hot waiter who has his eyes on her from the start.

Conrad and Laura start on separate journeys, exploring new possibilities in their marriage, and opening up to their hidden desires, fantasies, and needs. Will their journeys merge, or will Laura's “hobby job” make a hobby of their marriage?

The Hotwife Tattoo

When Greg's brother marries his wild, tattooed, ex-girlfriend Renee, he knows things will be a little complicated. But when Renee befriends his wife Sara, she starts to change in almost unbelievable ways. Greg sees that there is something more to Renee's plans than just friendly sister-in-law bonding. Is Renee's influence all bad, or can Greg get something he has always wanted and never admitted to is wife – maybe even himself?

The Tenant: A Very Naughty Hotwife Novel

Once upon a time, his exotic and incredibly sexy wife Anna loved to indulge Brian's fantasies...to a point. She teased strangers, and took them to cruel, tantalizing places. But she never went all the way. The game ended when Brian and Anna got married, and that was that.

Or was it?

When the gorgeous, charming, and very black John moves into their basement rental, Brian finds that his sleeping desires have been building up all these years. He doesn't just want Anna to tease. He isn't just toying with the idea. He is obsessed with driving his wife to do things with another

man. Lewd things. Obscene things.

When he confesses his desires, is Anna just a little bit too willing to make things just like old times? Is she too easy to push over each new line? Brian can't help but wonder if his own obsessions have gone too far...or if Anna's have.

A Gamble: The Making of A Hotwife

Ryan is just an average guy, coaxing his sweet, beautiful wife Victoria into playing into his hotwife fantasy – even if they're just pretending. But a trip to Vegas with his co-worker Brad and his sexy wife Irena turns Ryan's life upside-down. To help Ryan, Brad makes a proposal that could change everything...but it all centers on Victoria's innocence. How far will Victoria go to save what she holds most dear, now that her virtues, her love for Ryan, their marriage, Ryan's desires, and even their finances all hang in the balance? This is a 52,000-word novel about risk and romance, filled to the brim with the hard, steamy scenes you love. Please enjoy!

The Hotwife Summer

When Ben and Summer have the chance to spend the summer in Italy, their stale marriage starts to heat up in ways Ben could only have dreamed about. Summer is ready to take his hotwife fantasy all the way, and her choice is a sexy, Italian, Michelin star-studded chef. It's too late to put the brakes on what he's set in motion when Ben discovers the humiliating truth about Summer's choice of man. Summer has a taste for being naughty, and a filthy little plan of her own. Will it be everything he could wish for, or will Ben's cuckold fantasy turn into a nightmare he can't escape?

Well-Constructed Affairs

As a hot female construction engineer, John's wife Adria draws a lot of attention at the job site. Which isn't all bad. But when Adria opens the door for him to tell her about his sexual fantasies, he doesn't realize she has opened the door on her own – very dark - fantasy as well. A fantasy she hasn't shared with anyone until now. The couple are off on an exploration of

their desires...but is their marriage well-constructed enough to withstand the forces of their fantasies?

Nikita Gets In Too Deep

When Cole and his wife Nik arrive at their usual vacation spot in dull Cape Breton, they're taken by surprise by the most unlikely of next-door neighbors: ultra-sexy Paige and wealthy, commanding Mitch. And these new neighbors are full of surprises. Cole and Nik embark on new adventures in their marriage, trying new things and pushing boundaries they'd never even discussed. It's invigorating, but Cole can't help but wonder if his transformed wife hasn't gotten herself in too deep...

Not Black And White

When a photographer turns Rick on to the idea of watching his wife with another man, Rick feels an obsessive desire inside of himself catch fire. He can't help arrange for his shy, girl-next-door wife Danielle and the rugged, black photographer to cross paths. He knows that Drake Reyes' erotic photographs are not as abstract as they appear, and that Reyes sleeps with his married models. He knows his wife is not immune to Reyes' charms – no one is. He just can't help but imagine what it would be like to stand in his gallery, looking at Reyes' lurid photos, knowing his own wife is the model, knowing how the photos were taken. But was it really his idea, or have Drake and Danielle been as manipulative as he has?

Please note, this is the novelized version of the short story Black and White, with significant changes to all scenes depicted in the short story, as well as the point of view. There is, however, some repetition: scenarios which occurred in the short occur in the novel. There are plenty of fresh new adult scenes, however. Please enjoy.

A Dark Place: Cuckolded In Lagos

Three people are carving out their fortunes in Africa's largest city, but each of them holds a deeper, darker desire. What is the secret desire of the angelic Charlotte, who finds all men's eyes on her after dark in Lagos? What about Andrew, who keeps a secret hunger so buried perhaps he doesn't admit it even to himself? And what could be darker than Clement Ambode's already shadowy "*reliability*" as an all-purpose contractor in the underbelly of Lagos?

Charlotte, Andrew, and Clement will find themselves in a very dark place when their worlds collide in this ultra-sexy, novella-length cuckold story.

NOVELLAS BY ARNICA

Try To Have Some Fun

Poor Keith. He's been condemned to a campy cruise with his family and friends. Worse yet, he suspects something is going on between his wife and bad-boy Hank, the husband of a family friend his wife has invited along. Keith's in for a very big surprise – and much more naughty, adult fun than he expected on this cruise – when he finds out what's really going on.

Claire's Cowboy

When he gives his wife Claire the gift of a vacation of her choice, Chris is perplexed when she wants to go on a horseback-riding adventure in Montana. Nothing about that kind of trip has ever appealed to Claire. Next, she mentions a mysterious ex-lover, and she turns out to be nearly a professional at riding horses. Chris can't help but wonder if her choice of vacation, and the rugged man who will lead the tour, are just an uncanny coincidence...or if there is something more to Claire's cowboy?

Nothing Better To Do

Rob is finding out from the locals in his wife's small mountain hometown that his soccer-mom wife Kirsten may have been quite a different person once upon a time. He'll find out the truth first-hand when a late summer

blizzard traps everyone at a party, and his wife comes up with some very indecent ideas for passing the time.

After all, there's nothing better to do...

If you're a new fan of Arnica Butler, why don't you try [Wives Gone Wild?](#)

I've put together ten of my short stories about wives on vacation, who get taken every way you can think of while their husbands watch. **Ten stories for \$4.99!** For fans of my longer hotwife novels, these stories may not be for you (but then again...they might). These are quick or medium-length, dirty stories about men taking willing wives right out from under their husbands' noses. Most include very graphic scenes of humiliation, menage, cleanup and...well, that's all I can write about here!

Stories included in this bundle are: *Double-Cucked; Cuckolded in Texas by The Oil Tycoon; Watching My Wife Get Trucked; St. Paddy's Day Cucktale; A Long Hard Winter; Watching My Wife Get Lumberjacked; My Wife Goes Back To Black; Cuckolded On A Plane!; Cuckolded In Vegas!; and Cuckolded on My Dominican Vacation.*

All stories are available for purchase individually for \$2.99 and some are in Kindle Unlimited for free, with the exception of Cuckolded In Texas, which is only available here. I want to give readers a chance to read some of my earlier works and quickies at a discounted price.

Because sometimes, you just want to get down and dirty, right?
Enjoy!